

Sensors and Actuators Interfacing with Arduino and ESP32

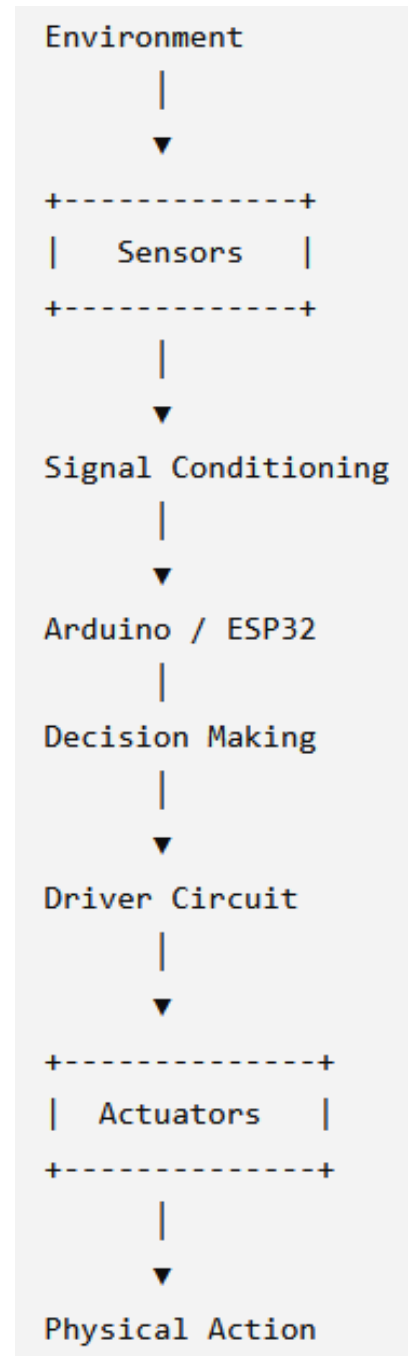
Dr. Hiran Ekanayake

University of Colombo School of Computing

2026

Sensors and Actuators Interfacing with Arduino and ESP32

- Arduino (especially the Arduino Uno R3) and ESP32 are among the most popular microcontroller platforms for interfacing with sensors and actuators. **Sensors** allow the microcontroller to perceive the environment, while **actuators** enable it to perform actions based on sensor inputs.

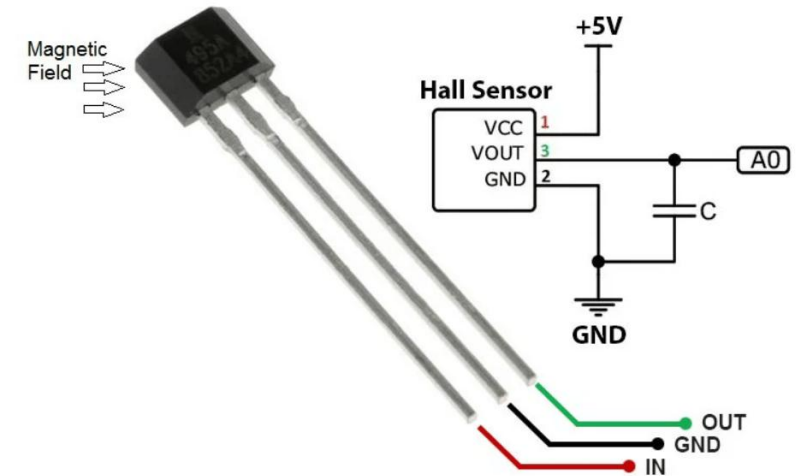
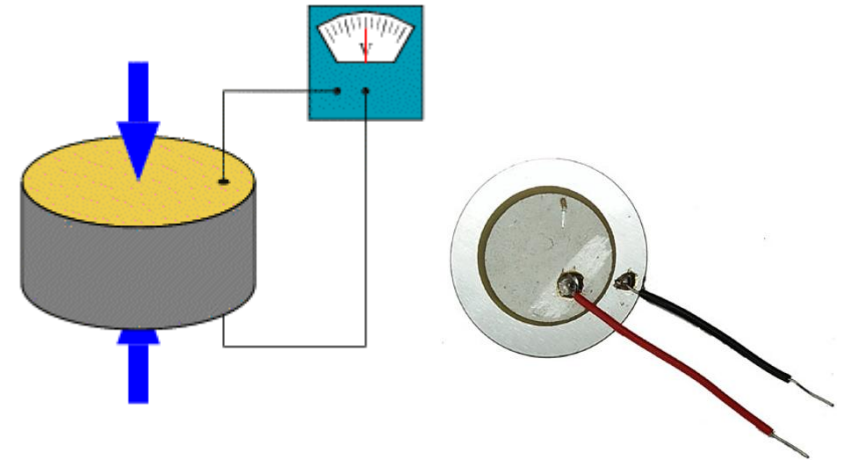


Classification of Sensors and Actuators

- Sensors and actuators can be classified in several ways depending on their operating principle, output type, application, power source, and method of interaction with the environment. Understanding these classifications helps in selecting suitable devices for Arduino, ESP32, robotics, industrial automation, IoT, and embedded systems.

Sensor Classification

- A. Based on Energy Source
 - **Active Sensors** (Self-generating)
 - Generate electrical signals without requiring external excitation.
 - Examples: Thermocouple, Piezoelectric sensor, Photovoltaic (solar) sensor, Tachogenerator
 - Advantages: No external excitation required, Suitable for remote applications
 - **Passive Sensors** (Require External Power)
 - Need an external voltage or current source.
 - Examples: RTD, Thermistor, LDR, Strain gauge, Hall effect sensor, Capacitive humidity sensor
 - Most Arduino and ESP32 sensors belong to this category.



Sensor Classification Cont.

- B. Based on Output Signal

- **Analog Sensors**

- Produce continuous signals.
 - Examples: LM35, LDR, Potentiometer, MQ Gas Sensors, Soil moisture sensor, Flex sensor, Pressure transducer

- **Digital Sensors**

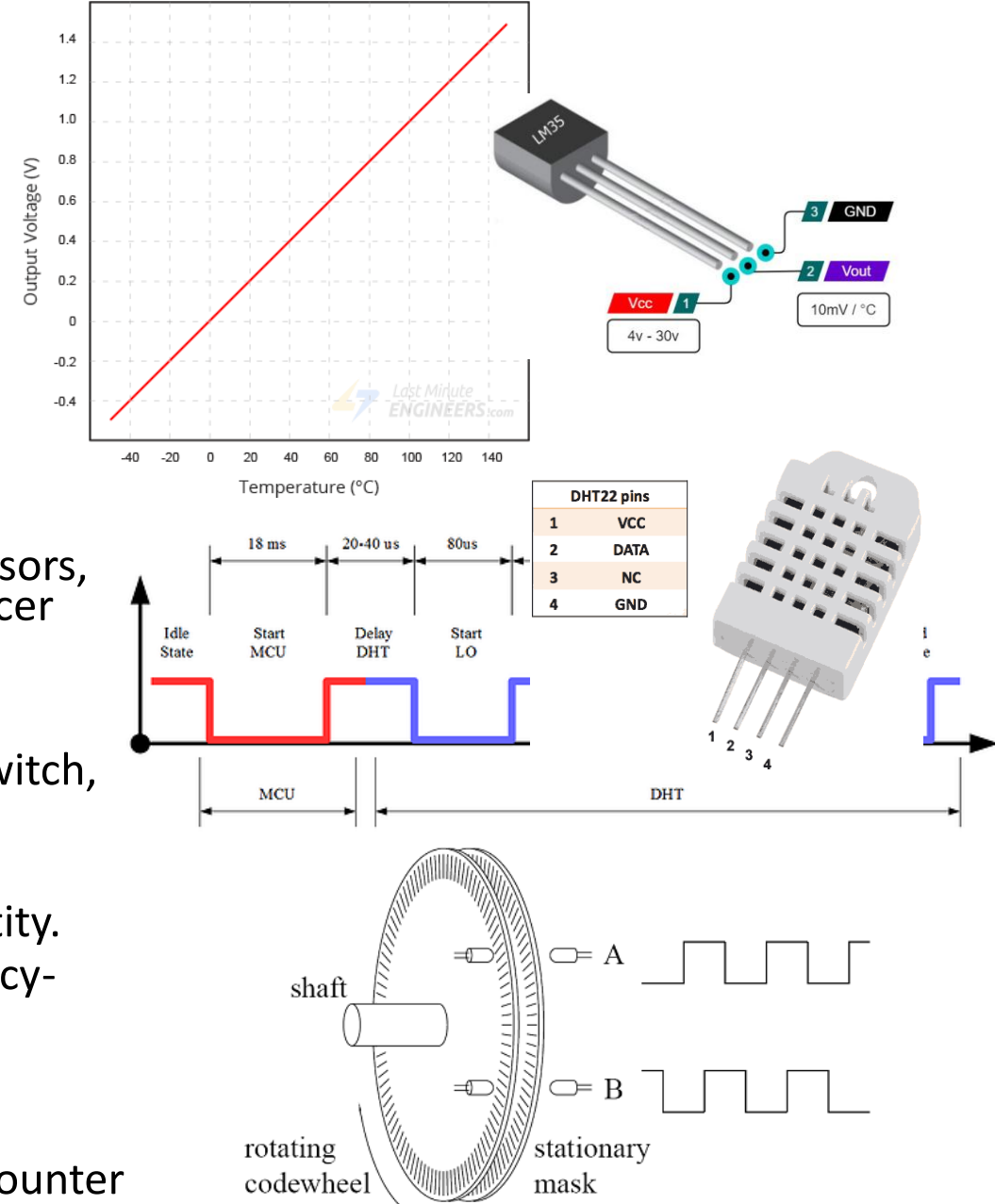
- Produce binary outputs or communicate digitally.
 - Examples: DHT22, DS18B20, BMP280, PIR, Reed switch, Hall switch

- **Frequency Output Sensors**

- Output frequency proportional to measured quantity.
 - Examples: Flow sensors, Rotary encoders, Frequency-output pressure sensors

- **Pulse Output Sensors**

- Produce pulses.
 - Examples: Water flow sensor, Rain gauge, Geiger counter



Sensor Classification Cont.

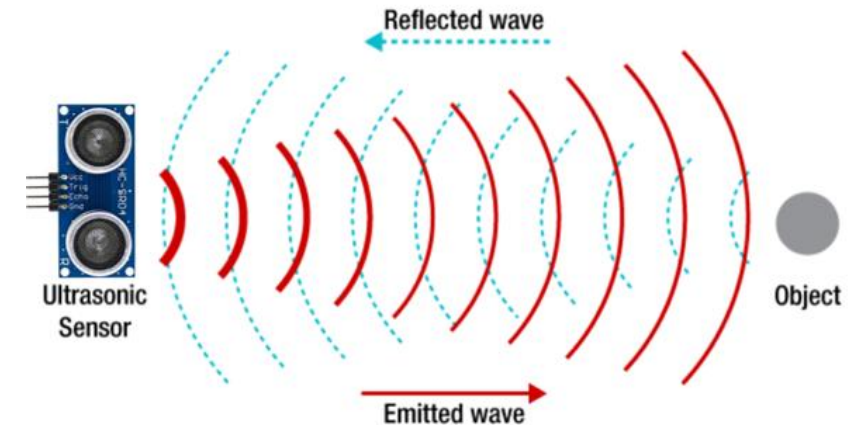
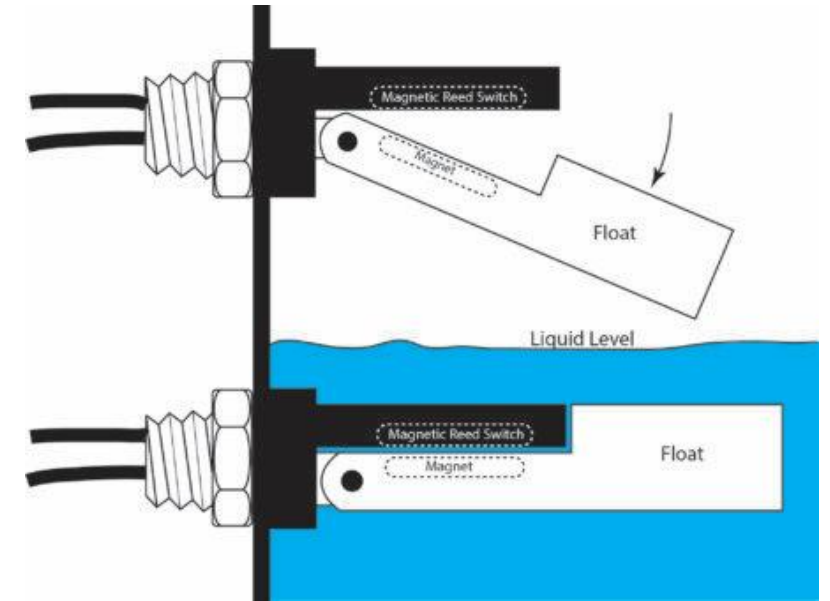
- C. Based on Contact

- **Contact Sensors**

- Need physical contact.
 - Examples: Push button, Float switch, Microswitch, Thermistor, Strain gauge

- **Non-contact Sensors**

- Detect objects remotely.
 - Examples: Ultrasonic, Infrared, Radar, LiDAR, Camera, Thermal camera



Sensor Classification Cont.

- D. Based on Physical Quantity Measured

- Temperature Sensors
- Humidity Sensors
- Pressure Sensors
- Force Sensors
- Position Sensors
- Distance Sensors
- Light Sensors
- Motion Sensors
- Magnetic Sensors

- Cont.

- Sound Sensors
- Gas Sensors
- Chemical Sensors
- Electrical Sensors
- Flow Sensors
- Level Sensors
- Image Sensors
- Biometric Sensors
- Environmental Sensors

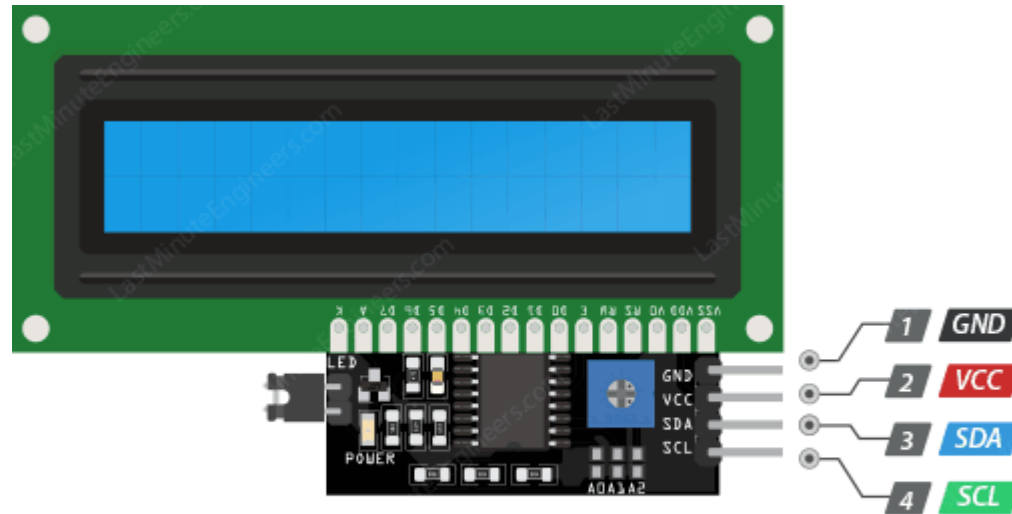
Sensor Classification Cont.

- E. Based on Transduction Principle

Principle	Examples
Resistive	LDR, Thermistor, Strain Gauge
Capacitive	Humidity, Touch sensor
Inductive	Metal detector, Proximity sensor
Piezoelectric	Vibration sensor
Optical	Photodiode, Camera
Magnetic	Hall sensor
Ultrasonic	HC-SR04
Thermal	Thermocouple
Electrochemical	Gas sensor, pH sensor
MEMS	Accelerometer, Gyroscope

Sensor Classification Cont.

- F. Based on Communication Interface
 - Analog
 - GPIO Digital
 - I²C
 - SPI
 - UART
 - CAN
 - RS-485
 - 1-Wire
 - I²S



I2C LCD Pinout

COMMUNICATION INTERFACES

Connect Sensors, Actuators & Modules with Arduino / ESP32 and Other MCUs



Different
Speeds



Multiple
Devices



Reliable
Communication



Easy
Integration



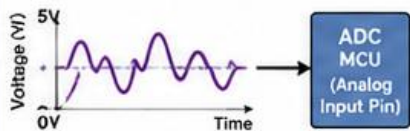
Noise
Resistant



Low Power
Options

1. ANALOG (ADC)

Continuous Voltage Signal



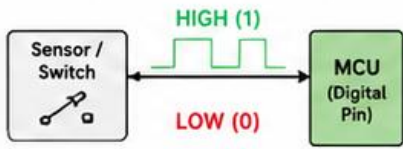
DESCRIPTION

Analog sensors output a continuous voltage that varies with the measured quantity. The MCU converts this voltage to a digital value using an ADC.

WIRING	Signal → Analog Pin
SPEED	-
DISTANCE	Short
EXAMPLES	LM35, LDR, Potentiometer, Microphone
APPLICATIONS	Measuring temperature, light, sound, pressure, humidity, position, etc.

2. GPIO DIGITAL

High / Low Signal



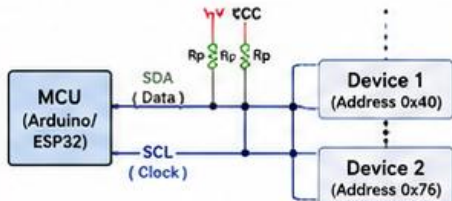
DESCRIPTION

Digital communication uses two states: HIGH (1) or LOW (0). Simple and widely used for switches, buttons, PIR sensors, relays, etc.

WIRING	Signal → Digital Pin
SPEED	Up to ~80 MHz (MCU dependent)
DISTANCE	Short
EXAMPLES	Push Button, PIR, Relay, Hall Sensor, Limit Switch, IR Sensor
APPLICATIONS	On/Off control, status signals, event detection

3. I²C (Inter-Integrated Circuit)

Two-Wire, Multi-Master



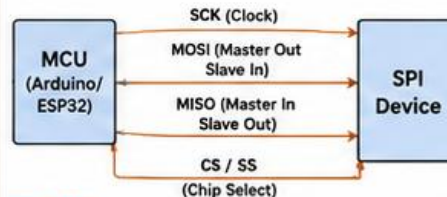
DESCRIPTION

I²C uses only two lines (SDA, SCL). Multiple devices share the same bus using unique addresses.

WIRING	SDA, SCL, GND, VCC (with pull-up resistors)
SPEED	100 kbps (Std), 400 kbps (Fast), 1 Mbps (Fm+)
DISTANCE	Up to ~1 m (short), can extend with buffers
EXAMPLES	OLED, LCD, BMP280, BME280, RTC, EEPROM, MPU6050
APPLICATIONS	Sensor networks, displays, data logging

4. SPI (Serial Peripheral Interface)

High-Speed, Full-Duplex



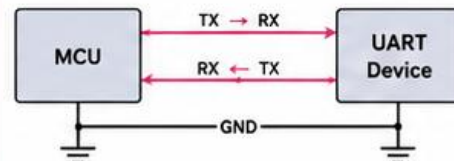
DESCRIPTION

SPI uses four main lines and a Chip Select (CS) line per device. High speed and full duplex communication.

WIRING	SCK, MOSI, MISO, CS, GND, VCC
SPEED	Up to tens of MHz (MCU dependent)
DISTANCE	Short (PCB traces / short cables)
EXAMPLES	SD Card, TFT Display, RFID (MFRC522), MAX7219, ADC (MCP3008)
APPLICATIONS	High-speed data transfer, displays, memory devices

5. UART (Universal Asynchronous Receiver Transmitter)

Asynchronous Serial Communication



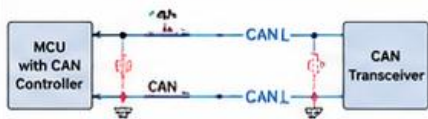
DESCRIPTION

UART uses two signal lines (TX, RX) and GND. Asynchronous communication – no clock line.

WIRING	TX, RX, GND
SPEED	Typical 9600 bps – 921600 bps+
DISTANCE	Short (TTL), Long with converters
EXAMPLES	GPS, GSM, Bluetooth (HC-05), LoRa Modules, Serial GPS
APPLICATIONS	Wireless modules, GPS, debugging, serial communication

6. CAN (Controller Area Network)

Robust, Multi-Master Bus



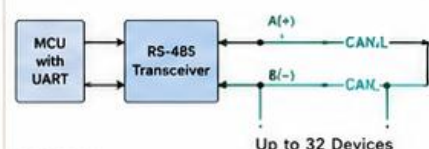
DESCRIPTION

CAN is a differential two-wire bus designed for robust communication in noisy environments.

WIRING	CAN_H, CAN_L, GND (120Ω termination)
SPEED	Up to 1 Mbps (bus length dependent)
DISTANCE	Up to 40 m @ 1 Mbps, up to 1 km @ 50 kbps
EXAMPLES	CAN Bus Modules (MCP2515 + TJA1050), Automotive ECUs
APPLICATIONS	Automotive, Industrial control, Robotics, Real-time systems

7. RS-485

Differential, Long Distance



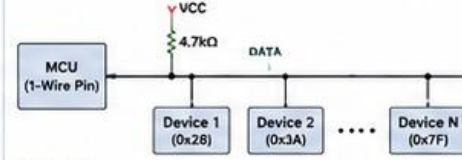
DESCRIPTION

RS-485 is a differential multi-drop network widely used in industrial applications.

WIRING	A(+), B(-), GND
SPEED	Up to 10 Mbps
DISTANCE	Up to 1200 m
EXAMPLES	MAX485, SN75176 Modules
APPLICATIONS	Industrial automation, Modbus RTU, sensor networks

8. 1-Wire

Single Data Line



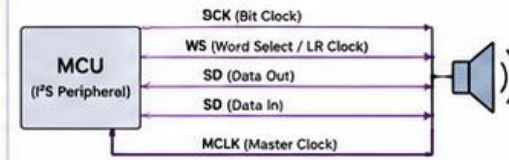
DESCRIPTION

1-Wire uses a single data line and GND. Devices have unique 64-bit addresses.

WIRING	DATA, GND (Pull-up resistor to VCC)
SPEED	16.3 kbps (standard)
DISTANCE	Up to ~30 m
EXAMPLES	DS18B20, EEPROM (DS2431), 1-Wire Key
APPLICATIONS	Temperature logging, identification, small sensor networks

9. I²S (Inter-IC Sound)

Digital Audio Interface



DESCRIPTION

I²S is a serial bus interface for digital audio data transfer between ICs.

WIRING	SCK, WS, SD (Out), SD (In), MCLK, GND
SPEED	Up to tens of MHz (audio sample rate)
DISTANCE	Short (on-board / short cables)
EXAMPLES	MEMS Microphones (INMP441), Audio DAC (PCMS102), MAX9837A
APPLICATIONS	Digital microphones, audio playback, voice capture, audio processing

INTERFACE COMPARISON

	ANALOG	+ Continuous signal (0-5V / 0-3.3V)
	GPIO DIGITAL	+ HIGH / LOW (0 or 1)
	I ² C	+ 2 wires, Multi-device Addressed
	SPI	+ High speed, Full duplex 4+ wires
	UART	+ 2 wires, Asynchronous Point-to-point
	CAN	+ Differential, Robust Multi-master
	RS-485	+ Differential, Long distance Multi-drop
	1-WIRE	+ Single data line Addressable devices
	I ² S	+ Digital audio High quality

TIPS

- Choose the right interface based on speed, distance, number of devices and application.
- Use pull-up resistors for I²C and 1-Wire.



GOOD PRACTICES

- Keep wires short for high speed buses (SPI, I²S).
- Use termination resistors for CAN and RS-485.



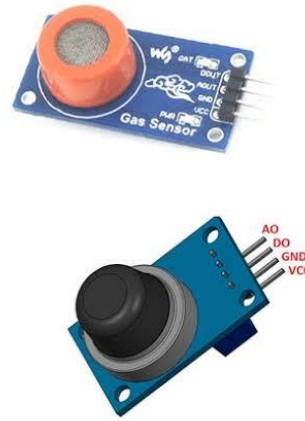
COMMON USE CASES



Different interfaces,
endless possibilities!

Sensor Classification Cont.

- G. Based on Application
 - Industrial sensors
 - Automotive sensors
 - Medical sensors
 - Agricultural sensors
 - Consumer electronics sensors
 - Aerospace sensors
 - Smart home sensors
 - Robotics sensors
 - IoT sensors
 - Wearable sensors



Actuator Classification

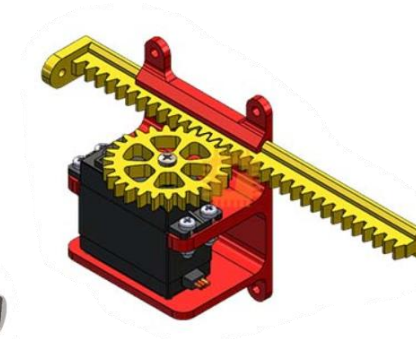
- Actuators convert electrical, pneumatic, hydraulic, or thermal energy into physical action.
- A. Based on Energy Source
 - **Electrical Actuators**
 - Examples: DC motor, Servo motor, Stepper motor, Solenoid, Relay, LED, Speaker
 - **Pneumatic Actuators**
 - Operate using compressed air. Examples: Pneumatic cylinder, Air gripper, Air motor
 - **Hydraulic Actuators**
 - Operate using pressurized fluid. Used in heavy machinery.
 - Examples: Hydraulic cylinder, Hydraulic motor
 - **Thermal Actuators**
 - Examples: Heater, Peltier module, Shape Memory Alloy (SMA)
 - **Piezoelectric Actuators**
 - Examples: Precision positioning stages, Ultrasonic transducers, Inkjet printer heads

Actuator Classification Cont.

- B. Based on Motion

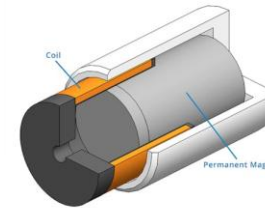
- **Linear Actuators**

- Produce straight-line motion.
 - Examples: Solenoid, Hydraulic cylinder, Pneumatic cylinder, Electric linear actuator



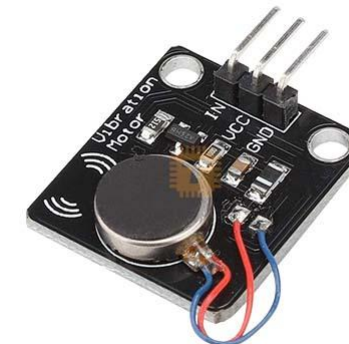
- **Rotary Actuators**

- Produce rotational motion.
 - Examples: DC motor, Servo motor, Stepper motor, AC motor, Brushless DC motor (BLDC)



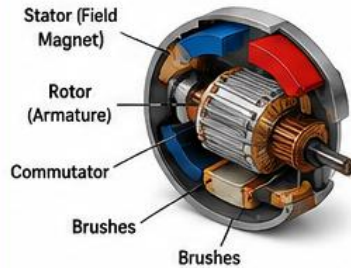
- **Oscillatory Actuators**

- Move back and forth.
 - Examples: Voice coil actuator, Vibrating motor

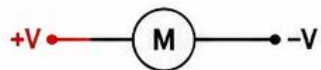


TYPES OF MOTORS – VISUAL DIAGRAM

1. DC MOTOR (Brushed)



WIRING DIAGRAM

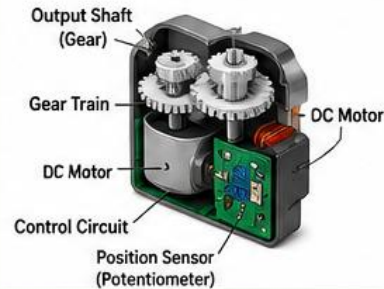


- Operates on DC supply
- Uses brushes and commutator
- Simple and inexpensive
- Speed control: Easy

Typical Uses:

Toys, Fans, Small robots, Power windows, DIY projects

2. SERVO MOTOR



WIRING DIAGRAM (3 WIRES)

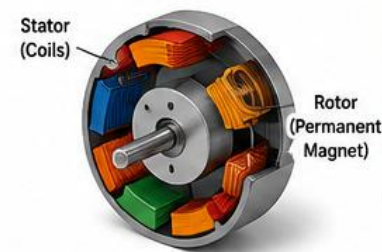
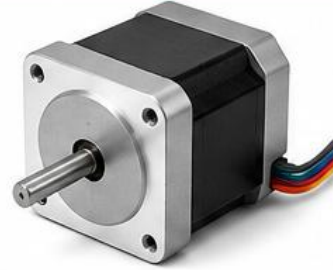


- Built-in control circuit
- Precise position control
- Controlled by PWM signal
- Limited rotation (~180°)

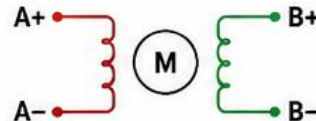
Typical Uses:

Robotics, RC cars, Drones, Camera gimbals, Automation

3. STEPPER MOTOR



WIRING DIAGRAM (Example: 4 Wires)



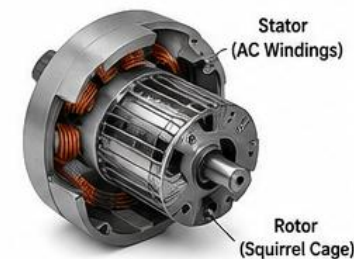
- Moves in precise steps
- Excellent for positioning
- No feedback required
- Higher torque at low speed

Typical Uses:

3D Printers, CNC machines, Plotters, Robotics, Automation

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4. AC MOTOR (Induction Motor)



WIRING DIAGRAM (Single Phase)

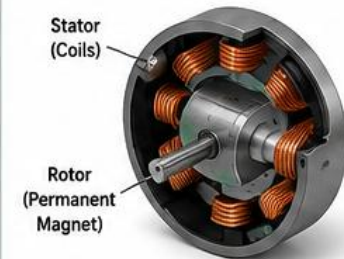


- Operates on AC supply
- Robust and reliable
- High power capability
- Speed control: VFD required

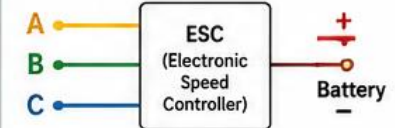
Typical Uses:

Industrial machines, Pumps, Fans, Compressors, Conveyors

5. BRUSHLESS DC MOTOR (BLDC Motor)



WIRING DIAGRAM (3 Wires to ESC)



- No brushes, high efficiency
- High speed and torque
- Long life, low maintenance
- Controlled by ESC (electronic)

Typical Uses:

Drones, Electric vehicles, RC planes, High performance apps

Actuator Classification Cont.

- C. Based on Control Method
 - **On-Off Actuators**
 - Examples: Relay, Solenoid, LED, Buzzer
 - **Proportional Actuators**
 - Output varies continuously.
 - Examples: Servo motor, BLDC motor, Proportional valve, Dimmable LED

Actuator Classification Cont.

- D. Based on Operating Principle

Principle	Examples
Electromagnetic	Relay, Solenoid
Electromechanical	Motor
Hydraulic	Hydraulic cylinder
Pneumatic	Pneumatic cylinder
Thermal	Heater, Peltier
Piezoelectric	Piezo actuator
Electrostatic	MEMS actuators
Shape Memory Alloy	Nitinol actuator

Actuator Classification Cont.

- E. Based on Function
 - Visual Actuators
 - LED, RGB LED, LCD, OLED, Seven-segment display
 - Audio Actuators
 - Buzzer, Speaker, Siren
 - Motion Actuators
 - Servo, Stepper, DC motor, BLDC motor, Linear actuator
 - Fluid Control Actuators
 - Solenoid valve, Motorized valve, Pump
 - Switching Actuators
 - Relay, Solid State Relay (SSR), Contactor
 - Heating/Cooling Actuators
 - Heating element, Peltier cooler, Fan

Actuator Classification Cont.

- F. Based on Communication
 - GPIO-controlled
 - PWM-controlled
 - Analog-controlled
 - I²C-controlled (e.g., PWM driver boards)
 - SPI-controlled
 - UART-controlled
 - CAN-controlled
 - Ethernet/Industrial fieldbus-controlled

Common Sensor & Actuator Modules

Note: The diagrams shown are intended for illustrative purposes only and may not accurately represent the actual appearance of the sensors and actuators. Likewise, the specifications, descriptions, and prices provided are approximate and may not be 100% accurate. Always refer to the manufacturer's datasheet and official documentation for precise technical information.



TEMPERATURE SENSORS

Popular Temperature Sensor Modules for Arduino / ESP32 Projects



Accurate
Measurement



Easy to
Interface



Reliable &
Durable



Wide Range
of Applications

LM35 MODULE



Linear temperature sensor
with analog output

Sensor / IC	LM35
Interface	Analog
Voltage Supply	2.7V – 5.5V DC
Temperature Range	-55°C to +150°C
Accuracy	±0.5°C @ 25°C
Resolution	10 mV / °C

★ Features

- Linear output (10 mV/°C)
- No external calibration
- Low self-heating
- Easy to use

Approx.
Price **\$1 – \$3**
(Rs. 350 – 1,000)

TMP36



Low voltage, low power
analog temperature sensor

Sensor / IC	TMP36
Interface	Analog
Voltage Supply	2.7V – 5.5V DC
Temperature Range	-40°C to +125°C
Accuracy	±0.5°C @ 25°C
Resolution	10 mV / °C

- Low power consumption
- Good linearity
- Stable and reliable

\$2 – \$4
(Rs. 700 – 1,400)

DS18B20 WATERPROOF



Digital temperature sensor
with 1-Wire interface

Sensor / IC	DS18B20
Interface	1-Wire
Voltage Supply	3.0V – 5.5V DC
Temperature Range	-55°C to +125°C
Accuracy	±0.5°C (-10°C to +85°C)
Resolution	9 to 12-bit (0.0625°C)

- Waterproof probe
- Unique 64-bit address
- Multi-drop (many sensors on single pin)
- No external components

\$2 – \$5
(Rs. 700 – 1,400)

MAX6675 + K-TYPE THERMOCOUPLE



Thermocouple amplifier for
high temperature measurement

Sensor / IC	MAX6675
Interface	SPI
Voltage Supply	3.0V – 5.5V DC
Temperature Range	0°C to +1024°C
Accuracy	±2°C (0°C to +700°C)
Resolution	0.25°C

- Works with K-Type thermocouple
- High temperature range
- Cold-junction compensation
- SPI digital output

\$6 – \$12
(Rs. 2,100 – 4,300)

MAX31855 THERMOCOUPLE AMPLIFIER



High accuracy thermocouple
amplifier with advanced features

Sensor / IC	MAX31855
Interface	SPI
Voltage Supply	3.0V – 5.5V DC
Temperature Range	-270°C to +1372°C
Accuracy	±0.25% (typ.)
Resolution	0.25°C

- Very high accuracy
- Wide temperature range
- Built-in fault detection
- Cold-junction compensation
- Open thermocouple detection

\$10 – \$18
(Rs. 3,500 – 6,500)

COMPARISON AT A GLANCE

	Temp. Range	Accuracy (typ.)	Interface
LM35 Module	-55°C to +150°C	±0.5°C	Analog
TMP36	-40°C to +125°C	±0.5°C	Analog
DS18B20 Waterproof	-55°C to +125°C	±0.5°C	1-Wire
MAX6675 + K-Type	0°C to +1024°C	±2°C	SPI
MAX31855	-270°C to +1372°C	±0.25%	SPI

APPLICATIONS



Weather
Stations



Industrial
Monitoring



HVAC
Systems



Cooking
& Ovens



3D Printers
& Makers



TIPS:

- For general purpose and low cost projects: LM35 or TMP36
- For long distance / waterproof applications: DS18B20
- For high temperature applications: MAX6675 or MAX31855

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Note: Always follow wiring diagram and use proper voltage supply.
Use filters and shielding for high noise environments.



HUMIDITY SENSORS

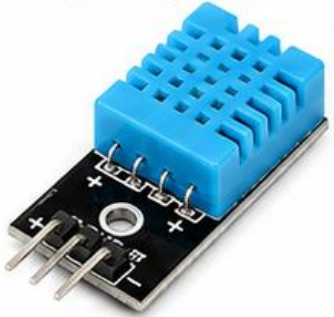
Popular Digital Humidity Sensors for Arduino / ESP32 / IoT Projects

- ✓ Measure Relative Humidity (RH)
- ✓ High Accuracy & Stability
- ✓ Low Power Consumption
- ✓ Easy Interface (Digital/I²C)



DHT11

Low-cost Digital Humidity & Temperature Sensor



FEATURES

- Humidity Range: 20 – 90 %RH
- Accuracy: ± 5 %RH
- Temperature Range: 0 – 50 °C
- Resolution: 1 %RH, 1 °C
- Interface: Single-Wire Digital
- Operating Voltage: 3.3 – 5.5 V
- Low cost, simple to use

Approx. Price: \$2 – \$3

DHT22 (AM2302)

High Accuracy Digital Humidity & Temperature Sensor



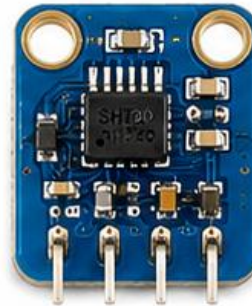
FEATURES

- Humidity Range: 0 – 100 %RH
- Accuracy: ± 2 %RH (typ.)
- Temperature Range: -40 – 80 °C
- Resolution: 0.1 %RH, 0.1 °C
- Interface: Single-Wire Digital
- Operating Voltage: 3.3 – 6 V
- More accurate & wider range

Approx. Price: \$4 – \$8

SHT20

Digital Humidity & Temperature Sensor (I²C)



FEATURES

- Humidity Range: 0 – 100 %RH
- Accuracy: ± 3 %RH
- Temperature Range: -40 – 125 °C
- Resolution: 0.04 %RH, 0.01 °C
- Interface: I²C (Addr: 0x40)
- Operating Voltage: 2.4 – 5.5 V
- Fast response, low power

Approx. Price: \$5 – \$8

SHT31

High Accuracy & Fast Response Humidity Sensor (I²C)



FEATURES

- Humidity Range: 0 – 100 %RH
- Accuracy: ± 2 %RH (typ.)
- Temperature Range: -40 – 125 °C
- Resolution: 0.01 %RH, 0.01 °C
- Interface: I²C (Addr: 0x44)
- Operating Voltage: 2.4 – 5.5 V
- Excellent stability & reliability

Approx. Price: \$6 – \$12

AHT20

Low Power Digital Humidity & Temperature Sensor (I²C)



FEATURES

- Humidity Range: 0 – 100 %RH
- Accuracy: ± 3 %RH
- Temperature Range: -40 – 85 °C
- Resolution: 0.024 %RH, 0.01 °C
- Interface: I²C (Addr: 0x38)
- Operating Voltage: 2.2 – 5.5 V
- Very low power consumption

Approx. Price: \$3 – \$6



Applications

Weather stations, Home automation, Greenhouses, IoT devices, Data loggers, HVAC systems, Smart agriculture and more.



Comparison at a Glance

- DHT11 – Best for beginners & low-cost projects
- DHT22 – Good accuracy and wide range
- SHT20 – Faster response with I²C interface
- SHT31 – Highest accuracy & stability
- AHT20 – Low power & compact size

Hiran Ekanayake @ UCSC



Interface Guide

DHT11 / DHT22 → Single-Wire Digital
SHT20 / SHT31 / AHT20 → I²C (SCL, SDA)



Scan for Datasheets & More Info



TEMPERATURE + HUMIDITY + PRESSURE SENSORS



Compact, Accurate and Reliable Environmental Sensing for Arduino, ESP32 & IoT Projects

BME280

Environmental Sensor



Temperature



Humidity



Pressure

FEATURES

- Measures Temperature, Humidity & Pressure
- High accuracy and long term stability
- Low power consumption (3.3 μ A)
- Wide supply voltage: 1.8V – 3.6V
- Small size: 2.5 x 2.5 x 0.93 mm



T Accuracy

$\pm 1.0^{\circ}\text{C}$



RH Accuracy

$\pm 3\%$



Pressure Accuracy

$\pm 1\text{ hPa}$

Interface
I²C / SPI

Approx. Price
USD 5 – 10

BME680

Environmental Sensor



Temperature



Humidity



Pressure



Gas / VOC

FEATURES

- Temperature, Humidity, Pressure + Gas/VOC
- Integrated gas sensor for air quality (IAQ)
- Detects VOC, CO, ethanol, NH₃, etc.
- Low power with advanced algorithms
- Ideal for indoor air quality monitoring



T Accuracy

$\pm 1.0^{\circ}\text{C}$



RH Accuracy

$\pm 3\%$



Pressure Accuracy

$\pm 1\text{ hPa}$



Gas Accuracy

Up to 500 $^{\circ}\text{C}$

Interface
I²C / SPI

Approx. Price
USD 10 – 18

BMP280

Pressure + Temperature Sensor



Temperature



Pressure

FEATURES

- Measures Pressure and Temperature
- High precision and excellent linearity
- Low power consumption (2.7 μ A)
- Wide pressure range: 300 – 1100 hPa
- Ideal for altitude and weather apps



T Accuracy

$\pm 1.0^{\circ}\text{C}$



Pressure Accuracy

$\pm 1\text{ hPa}$

Interface
I²C / SPI

Approx. Price
USD 3 – 6

BMP180

Pressure + Temperature Sensor



Temperature



Pressure

FEATURES

- Measures Pressure and Temperature
- Very low power and easy to use
- Pressure range: 300 – 1100 hPa
- Good accuracy for general applications
- Great for weather stations & drones



T Accuracy

$\pm 1.0^{\circ}\text{C}$



Pressure Accuracy

$\pm 1\text{ hPa}$

Interface
I²C

Approx. Price
USD 2 – 4



APPLICATIONS



Weather
Stations



Drones &
UAVs



IoT
Monitoring



Smart Home
Automation



Agriculture
Monitoring



Data Loggers
& Research

Why Choose These Sensors?

- ✓ Compact size and easy integration
- ✓ Low power for battery operated systems
- ✓ High accuracy and long term stability
- ✓ Works with Arduino, ESP32, Raspberry Pi and more



Detect
Light



High
Accuracy



Low Power
Consumption

LIGHT SENSORS

Measure Light Intensity, Color & Ambient Illumination



Easy to
Interface



Wide
Applications



Energy
Efficient

LDR (Photoresistor)



ANALOG (Resistive)

FEATURES

- Simple and Low Cost
- Wider detection range
- High sensitivity to visible light
- Can be used with voltage divider
- Analog output (resistance changes with light)

☀ Light Range : ~ 1 – 100,000 Lux

⚡ Operating Voltage : 3.3V – 5V

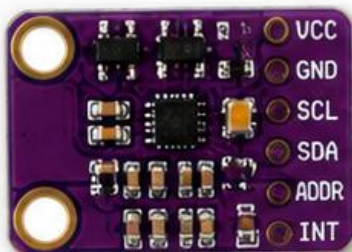
APPLICATIONS



- Street light control
- Automatic brightness control
- Day/Night detection

Approx. Price: \$0.5 – \$2

BH1750



DIGITAL (I²C)

FEATURES

- Digital ambient light sensor
- High accuracy and resolution (16-bit)
- Wide measurement range
- Built-in ADC
- I²C interface (3.3V / 5V compatible)

☀ Light Range : 1 – 65,535 Lux

⚡ Operating Voltage : 2.4V – 3.6V

APPLICATIONS



- Display backlight control
- Camera exposure control
- Indoor light measurement

Approx. Price: \$2 – \$4

TSL2561



DIGITAL (I²C)

FEATURES

- High precision light-to-digital converter
- Wide dynamic range (up to 100,000:1)
- Measures full spectrum IR & visible light
- Programmable gain and timing
- Interrupt output available

☀ Light Range : 0.1 – 40,000 Lux

⚡ Operating Voltage : 2.7V – 3.6V

APPLICATIONS



- Smart home lighting
- Industrial light monitoring
- Lux meter, data loggers

Approx. Price: \$5 – \$8

TCS3200



DIGITAL (Frequency Output)

FEATURES

- Color light sensor (RGB)
- Detects Red, Green, Blue components
- Frequency output proportional to light intensity
- Adjustable sensitivity
- Works with or without IR filter

☀ Light Range : Depends on Color & Filter

⚡ Operating Voltage : 2.7V – 5V

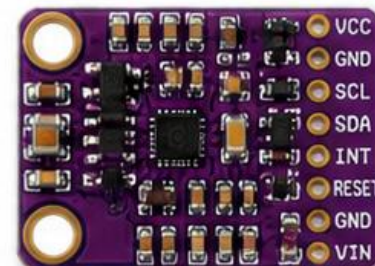
APPLICATIONS



- Color detection and sorting
- RGB LED control
- Robotics, education projects

Approx. Price: \$3 – \$6

APDS9960



DIGITAL (I²C)

FEATURES

- 4-in-1 Sensor (Ambient Light, RGB, Proximity, Gesture)
- Built-in IR LEDs for proximity & gesture
- High sensitivity & low power
- I²C interface
- Programmable interrupts

☀ Light Range : 0 – 65,535 Lux

⚡ Operating Voltage : 2.4V – 3.6V

APPLICATIONS



- Gesture recognition
- Touchless controls
- Mobile & IoT devices

Approx. Price: \$6 – \$10



DID YOU KNOW?

Light sensors are used in automatic street lights, smartphone brightness control, camera exposure, solar trackers, smart home systems and many more applications.

INTERFACES EXPLAINED

Analog: Outputs a variable voltage | I²C: Two-wire digital communication (SDA, SCL)

Frequency Output: Outputs a square wave whose frequency changes with light intensity



TIPS

Use proper libraries, decoupling capacitors and correct voltage levels for accurate readings.



DISTANCE / PROXIMITY SENSORS

Types, Features & Applications



Distance and proximity sensors detect the presence or distance of objects without (or with minimal) physical contact.

1. HC-SR04 (Ultrasonic Sensor)



Range: 2 – 400 cm

Interface: Digital (Trig / Echo)

FEATURES

- Low cost
- Easy to use
- 15° measuring angle
- Works in most lighting conditions

APPLiCATIONS

- Obstacle detection
- Robot navigation
- Distance measurement
- Parking assist

Price: USD \$2 – \$4

2. JSN-SR04T (Waterproof Ultrasonic)



Range: 20 – 600 cm

Interface: Digital (Trig / Echo)

FEATURES

- Waterproof (IP68)
- Longer range
- High accuracy
- Suitable for outdoor use

Applications

- Tank level measurement
- Outdoor robot navigation
- Flood monitoring
- Industrial automation

Price: USD \$5 – \$8

3. VL53L0X (Time-of-Flight ToF)



Range: 2 cm – 2 m

Interface: I²C

FEATURES

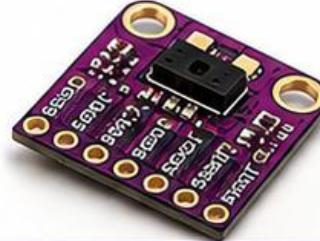
- Time-of-Flight technology
- High accuracy ($\pm 3\%$)
- Small size
- Immune to IR interference

Applications

- Gesture detection
- Robot obstacle avoidance
- Presence detection
- Level sensing

Price: USD \$5 – \$10

4. VL53L1X (Advanced ToF Sensor)



Range: 4 cm – 4 m

Interface: I²C

FEATURES

- Longer range than VL53L0X
- High speed (up to 400 kHz)
- Multi-zone detection
- Better ambient light immunity

Applications

- Robotics
- People counting
- Level measurement
- Industrial automation

Price: USD \$10 – \$20

5. Sharp GP2Y0A21YK0F (IR Distance Sensor)



Range: 10 – 80 cm

Interface: Analog

FEATURES

- IR triangulation method
- Compact size
- Good linearity
- Low power consumption

Applications

- Robot navigation
- Industrial equipment
- Object detection
- Level sensing

Price: USD \$10 – \$15

6. TFmini LiDAR Module (Laser Distance Sensor)



Range: 0.1 – 12 m

Interface: UART (Serial)

FEATURES

- Laser (ToF) measurement
- High accuracy (± 2 cm)
- Long range up to 12 m
- Compact and lightweight

Applications

- Robot mapping
- Obstacle detection
- Drones
- Industrial automation

Price: USD \$35 – \$50

QUICK COMPARISON

Technology	Ultrasonic	Ultrasonic (Waterproof)	Time-of-Flight (ToF)	Advanced ToF	Infrared (Analog)	LiDAR (Laser ToF)
Typical Range	2 – 400 cm	20 – 600 cm	2 cm – 2 m	4 cm – 4 m	10 – 80 cm	0.1 – 12 m
Accuracy	~ 3 mm	~ 5 mm	$\pm 3\%$	± 2 cm	~ 1 cm	± 2 cm
Best For	Low cost projects, general purpose	Outdoor & waterproof applications	Short range, compact & precise measurement	Longer range ToF & multi-zone detection	Analog output & compact designs	Long range, high precision applications

TIPS

- Use ultrasonic sensors for general purpose and cost sensitive projects.
- Use ToF sensors (VL53L0X / VL53L1X) for accurate and compact distance measurement.
- Use LiDAR (TFmini) for long range and high precision applications.
- Avoid using ultrasonic sensors in soft/fabric or very noisy environments.
- Check ambient light conditions when using IR sensors.



MOTION SENSORS

Detect Movement, Motion, Orientation and Vibration for Smart Projects

Why Motion Sensors?

- ✓ Detect presence, movement & motion
- ✓ Improve automation & energy efficiency
- ✓ Essential for Robotics, IoT & Security
- ✓ Easy to interface with Arduino / ESP32

1. PIR MOTION SENSOR (HC-SR501)



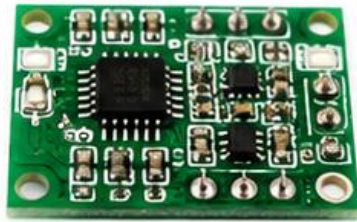
Detects movement of people or animals by sensing infrared radiation changes.

FEATURES

- 🎯 Detection Range: 3 – 7 meters
- 📐 Detection Angle: ~120°
- ⚡ Operating Voltage: 4.5 – 20V DC
- 📡 Output: Digital (HIGH/LOW)
- ⚙️ Typical Current: 50 – 80 μ A
- 🧩 Applications: Security systems, Lighting control, Automation

Approx. Price: \$2 – \$4

2. MICROWAVE RADAR SENSOR (RCWL-0516)



Uses Doppler radar to detect movement through objects like plastic, glass or thin walls.

FEATURES

- 🎯 Detection Range: 1 – 7 meters
- ⚡ Operating Voltage: 4 – 28V DC
- 📡 Output: Digital (HIGH/LOW)
- ⚙️ Adjustable Sensitivity and Hold Time
- 📡 Works through non-metallic materials
- 🧩 Applications: Touchless switches, Smart lighting, Occupancy detection

Approx. Price: \$2 – \$5

3. VIBRATION SENSOR (SW-420)



Detects vibrations or shocks from moving or vibrating objects.

FEATURES

- 📡 Detection Type: Vibration / Shock
- ⚡ Operating Voltage: 3.3 – 5V DC
- 📡 Output: Digital (HIGH/LOW)
- ⚙️ Sensitivity: Adjustable
- 💡 Onboard LED Indicator
- 🧩 Applications: Alarm systems, Robot collision, Machine monitoring

Approx. Price: \$1 – \$3

4. TILT SENSOR (KY-020 / SW-520D)



Detects tilting or orientation change from its reference position.

FEATURES

- 📐 Tilt Angle: ~10 – 15°
- ⚡ Operating Voltage: 3.3 – 5V DC
- 📡 Output: Digital (HIGH/LOW)
- 📦 Small Size & Easy to use
- 💡 Onboard LED Indicator
- 🧩 Applications: Anti-theft devices, Level detection, Robotics

Approx. Price: \$1 – \$2

5. 6-AXIS IMU (MOTION MODULE) (MPU6050)



Combines 3-axis accelerometer and 3-axis gyroscope to detect motion, rotation and orientation.

FEATURES

- 📡 Accelerometer Range: $\pm 2g$, $\pm 4g$, $\pm 8g$, $\pm 16g$
- 📡 Gyroscope Range: ± 250 , ± 500 , ± 1000 , ± 2000 °/s
- 📡 Interface: I2C (Default) / SPI
- ⚡ Operating Voltage: 3.3 – 5V DC
- 🧩 Applications: Robotics, Drones, Gesture control, Stabilization

Approx. Price: \$3 – \$6

COMMON APPLICATIONS



Security Systems



Automatic Lighting



Alarm Systems



Robotics & Automation



Smart Home Projects



Occupancy Detection



Drones & Navigation



Condition Monitoring

INTERFACING

- Digital Output → Connect to GPIO pins
- Analog Output → Read via ADC
- I2C / SPI → Connect to respective pins
- Compatible with Arduino, ESP32, Raspberry Pi



Note: Prices are approximate and may vary by region and supplier.



IMU (ACCELEROMETER / GYROSCOPE) SENSORS

— Measure Motion, Orientation & Acceleration in 3D Space —



Drones



Robotics



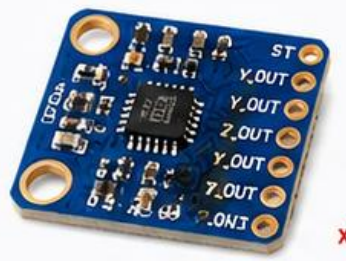
Vehicle Stability



Motion Tracking

ADXL335

3-Axis Analog Accelerometer



Low cost, analog output accelerometer for basic motion and tilt measurements.

Type	Accelerometer
Axes	3-Axis (X, Y, Z)
Range	± 3 g
Output	Analog Voltage
Supply Voltage	1.8V – 3.6V
Interface	Analog
Noise	220 $\mu\text{g}/\sqrt{\text{Hz}}$

Features

- Wide supply range (1.8V – 3.6V)
- Low power consumption (~350 μA)
- Analog outputs for X, Y, Z axes
- Small size and easy to use

Applications

- Tilt detection
- Vibration measurement
- Simple motion sensing

\$3 – \$5

ADXL345

3-Axis Digital Accelerometer



High resolution digital accelerometer with advanced features and low power.

Type	Accelerometer
Axes	3-Axis (X, Y, Z)
Range	$\pm 2 / \pm 4 / \pm 8 / \pm 16$ g
Output	Digital (16-bit)
Supply Voltage	2.0V – 3.6V
Interface	I ² C / SPI
Noise	~220 $\mu\text{g}/\sqrt{\text{Hz}}$

Features

- High resolution (13-bit)
- FIFO buffer, Activity/Inactivity detection
- Tap/Double Tap detection
- Free-fall detection

Applications

- Motion logging
- Step counter / Pedometer
- Vibration analysis

\$4 – \$7

MPU6050

6-Axis Accelerometer + Gyroscope



Popular 6-axis IMU combining a 3-axis accelerometer and 3-axis gyroscope.

Type	Accelerometer + Gyroscope
Axes	6-Axis (3 Accel + 3 Gyro)
Accel Range	$\pm 2 / \pm 4 / \pm 8 / \pm 16$ g
Gyro Range	$\pm 250 / \pm 500 / \pm 1000 / \pm 2000$ °/s
Output	Digital (16-bit)
Supply Voltage	3.0V – 5.0V
Interface	I ² C
Features	DMP (Motion Processing Unit) Built-in Temperature Sensor

- 6-axis motion tracking
- DMP for sensor fusion (Quaternion, Euler)
- Low power consumption
- Widely supported by libraries

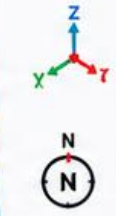
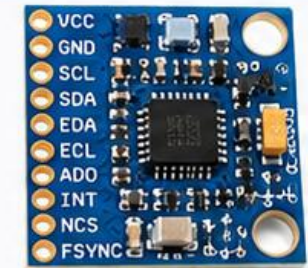
Applications

- Drones & RC Aircraft
- Robotics & Balancing
- Motion tracking & VR

\$3 – \$6

MPU9250

9-Axis IMU (Accel + Gyro + Magnetometer)



Advanced 9-axis IMU with AK8963 magnetometer for orientation and heading.

Type	9-Axis IMU
Axes	3 Accel + 3 Gyro + 3 Mag
Accel Range	$\pm 2 / \pm 4 / \pm 8 / \pm 16$ g
Gyro Range	$\pm 250 / \pm 500 / \pm 1000 / \pm 2000$ °/s
Mag Range	± 4800 μT
Output	Digital (16-bit)
Supply Voltage	3.0V – 5.0V
Interface	I ² C / SPI

Features

- 9-axis sensor fusion
- Integrated AK8963 magnetometer
- Excellent for orientation & navigation
- Low power with multiple modes

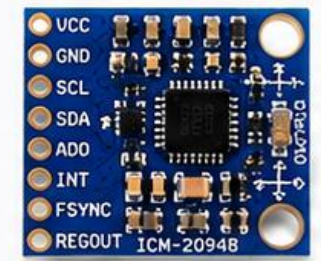
Applications

- Drones, UAVs & Navigation
- Robotics & SLAM
- AR/VR & Motion Capture

\$8 – \$15

ICM-20948

9-Axis IMU (High Performance)



High performance 9-axis IMU with low noise and high accuracy.

Type	9-Axis IMU
Axes	3 Accel + 3 Gyro + 3 Mag
Accel Range	$\pm 2 / \pm 4 / \pm 8 / \pm 16$ g
Gyro Range	$\pm 250 / \pm 500 / \pm 1000 / \pm 2000$ °/s
Mag Range	± 4900 μT
Output	Digital (16-bit)
Supply Voltage	2.5V – 3.3V
Interface	I ² C / SPI

Features

- Very low noise & high stability
- Advanced sensor fusion (DMP)
- Supports up to 1125 Hz data rate
- Excellent temperature stability

Applications

- High end drones & gimbals
- Industrial & Automotive
- Precision Motion Tracking

\$10 – \$20

COMMON IMU TERMS

- Accelerometer : Measures acceleration due to gravity or motion (in g)
- Gyroscope : Measures angular velocity (in °/s)
- Magnetometer : Measures magnetic field (in μT) for heading
- IMU : Combination of sensors for complete motion tracking

INTERFACE TYPES

I²C
2-Wire Interface
Easy to use

SPI
High Speed
Interface

Analog
Simple
Output

TYPICAL APPLICATIONS

Drones & UAVs

Robotics

Wearables

Industrial Automation

Balance Systems

Navigation & Mapping

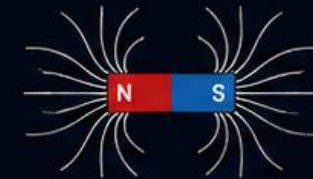


Scan for Datasheets & Projects



MAGNETIC SENSORS

Detect Magnetic Fields | Position | Speed | Direction



1. HALL EFFECT SENSOR (A3144 / 49E / SS49E)



Detects magnetic field using Hall Effect.

FEATURES

- Detects presence of magnetic field
- Digital Output (High / Low)
- Operates from 2.5V – 24V
- Low power consumption
- Fast response
- Used for proximity sensing, speed detection, RPM measurement

INTERFACE

Digital (GPIO)
USD \$1 – \$2

2. REED SWITCH (Normally Open / NC)



Mechanical switch operated by magnetic field.

FEATURES

- Simple and reliable
- No power required
- Normally Open (NO) / Normally Closed (NC)
- Long life
- Used in door sensors, alarms, position detection

INTERFACE

Digital (Switch)
USD \$1 – \$2

3. HMC5883L COMPASS MODULE (3-Axis Magnetometer)



3-axis digital compass for measuring magnetic field in X, Y, Z axes.

FEATURES

- 3-Axis measurement (X, Y, Z)
- High sensitivity (± 8 gauss)
- I²C Interface (up to 400 kHz)
- Operating voltage: 2.16V – 3.6V
- Used in compasses, navigation, robotics, orientation sensing

INTERFACE

I²C
PRICE (Approx.)
USD \$4 – \$8

4. QMC5883L COMPASS MODULE (3-Axis Magnetometer)



High performance 3-axis digital magnetometer.

FEATURES

- 3-Axis measurement (X, Y, Z)
- Wide range (± 8 Gauss)
- High resolution (16-bit)
- I²C Interface (up to 400 kHz)
- Operating voltage: 2.7V – 3.6V
- Low power consumption
- Used in drones, GPS, robotics, navigation systems

INTERFACE

I²C
PRICE (Approx.)
USD \$4 – \$7

5. GIANT MAGNETORESISTIVE (GMR) SENSOR (AMC7120 / NVE Series)



Detects extremely small magnetic fields using GMR technology.

FEATURES

- Very high sensitivity
- Wide supply range (2.7V – 5.5V)
- Analog output (Proportional)
- Low noise, high stability
- Used in precision current sensing, linear position sensing, industrial and automotive applications

INTERFACE

Analog Output
PRICE (Approx.)
USD \$3 – \$10

COMMON APPLICATIONS



RPM & Speed Measurement



Robotics & Automation



Position & Proximity Detection



Security & Alarm Systems



Compass & Navigation



Automotive Systems

HOW THEY WORK



Magnetic Field



Sensor Detects Field Change



Converts to Electrical Signal



Processed by Microcontroller

TIPS FOR USE

- ✓ Keep sensors away from strong magnets & motors.
- ✓ Use proper power supply & decoupling capacitors.
- ✓ Calibrate compass sensors for accurate readings.
- ✓ Follow datasheet guidelines for best performance.



Magnetic sensors are widely used in modern electronics for non-contact sensing, precision measurement and smart automation.

GAS / AIR QUALITY SENSORS

Detect harmful gases, VOCs and pollutants for a safer and healthier environment



Better Air Quality



Health Protection



Energy Efficiency



Data Driven Monitoring



Smart & Green Environment

MQ-2

Smoke, LPG, Propane, Hydrogen, Methane



FEATURES

- Detects LPG, Smoke, Alcohol, Propane, Hydrogen, Methane
- High sensitivity and fast response
- Adjustable sensitivity (potentiometer)
- Wide detection range
- Long life and low cost

DETECTION RANGE

200 – 10,000 ppm

INTERFACE

Analog (AO) / Digital (DO)



APPROX. PRICE
USD \$2 – \$5

MQ-3

Alcohol, Ethanol



FEATURES

- High sensitivity to Alcohol (Ethanol)
- Good stability and long life
- Fast response and quick recovery
- Adjustable sensitivity
- Simple drive circuit

DETECTION RANGE

0.05 – 10 mg/L (Alcohol)

INTERFACE

Analog (AO) / Digital (DO)



APPROX. PRICE
USD \$2 – \$5

MQ-4

Methane, CNG



FEATURES

- High sensitivity to Methane (CH₄) and CNG
- Fast response
- Stable performance
- Adjustable sensitivity
- Low power consumption

DETECTION RANGE

200 – 10,000 ppm (CH₄)

INTERFACE

Analog (AO) / Digital (DO)



APPROX. PRICE
USD \$2 – \$5

MQ-7

Carbon Monoxide (CO)



FEATURES

- High sensitivity to CO
- Good selectivity and stability
- Fast response and high reliability
- Simple drive circuit
- Long life

DETECTION RANGE

20 – 2,000 ppm (CO)

INTERFACE

Analog (AO) / Digital (DO)



APPROX. PRICE
USD \$2 – \$5

MQ-135

Air Quality, NH₃, NO_x, Benzene, Smoke, CO₂



FEATURES

- Detects NH₃, NO_x, Benzene, Smoke, CO₂ and other gases
- High sensitivity and wide detection
- Fast response
- Good stability and long life
- Adjustable sensitivity

DETECTION RANGE

10 – 10,000 ppm

INTERFACE

Analog (AO) / Digital (DO)



APPROX. PRICE
USD \$2 – \$5

CCS811

eCO₂, TVOC, Air Quality



FEATURES

- Measures eCO₂ (Equivalent CO₂) and TVOC
- Digital output (I²C)
- Low power consumption
- Built-in temperature and humidity compensation
- Ideal for IAQ monitoring

DETECTION RANGE

eCO₂: 400 – 8,192 ppm
TVOC: 0 – 1,188 ppb

INTERFACE

I²C (3.3V / 5V compatible)



APPROX. PRICE
USD \$8 – \$15

SGP30

VOC, Air Quality



FEATURES

- Detects VOC (Volatile Organic Compounds)
- Digital output (I²C)
- Low power consumption
- Built-in compensation for humidity and temperature
- Great for smart homes, HVAC, and monitoring

DETECTION RANGE

0 – 60,000 ppb VOC

INTERFACE

I²C (3.3V / 5V compatible)



APPROX. PRICE
USD \$10 – \$20

BME680

Gas, Pressure, Temp., Humidity (Environmental)



FEATURES

- Measures Gas, Pressure, Temperature and Humidity
- Detects VOC, CO₂ equivalent and air quality
- High accuracy and stability
- Low power consumption
- Smart indoor air quality monitoring

DETECTION RANGE

VOC: 0 – 60,000 ppb
Pressure: 300 – 1,100 hPa

INTERFACE

I²C / SPI (3.3V)



APPROX. PRICE
USD \$10 – \$18

TYPICAL APPLICATIONS



Air Quality Monitoring



Smart Home Automation



Industrial Safety



HVAC Systems



Environmental Monitoring



IoT & Smart Devices



TIPS FOR BEST RESULTS

- Calibrate sensors in clean air for accurate readings.
- Keep sensors away from water, alcohol vapors and high humidity.
- Allow warm-up time (24–48 hours) for MQ sensors for stable output.
- Use proper filtering and placement for reliable measurements.

Hiran Ekanayake @Hirana

NOTE

MQ series sensors are analog and need calibration. CCS811, SGP30 and BME680 are digital sensors with better accuracy and long term stability.



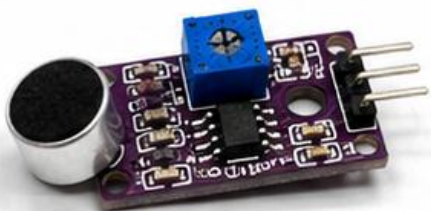
SOUND SENSORS

DETECT • MEASURE • LISTEN

Sound sensors convert sound waves into electrical signals that can be measured and processed by microcontrollers like Arduino or ESP32.



1. KY-037 SOUND SENSOR MODULE



FEATURES

- Uses LM393 comparator
- Digital output (DO) and Analog output (AO)
- Adjustable sensitivity (via potentiometer)
- Operating voltage: 3.3V – 5V DC
- Detects sound intensity level
- Onboard indicator LED
- Good for simple sound detection

Voltage 3.3V – 5V Output DO, AO Price \$1 – \$2

2. KY-038 MICROPHONE SENSOR MODULE



FEATURES

- Uses LM993 comparator
- Digital (DO) and Analog (AO) outputs
- Sensitivity adjustable
- Operating voltage: 3.3V – 5V DC
- Detects claps, knocks, loud sounds
- Compact and easy to use
- Indicator LED for output status

Voltage 3.3V – 5V Output DO, AO Price \$1 – \$2

3. MAX9814 MICROPHONE AMPLIFIER

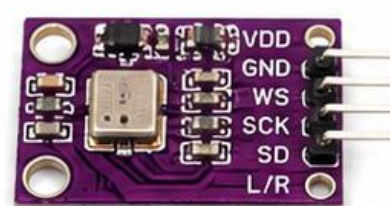


FEATURES

- High sensitivity electret microphone amp
- Automatic Gain Control (AGC)
- Adjustable gain via potentiometer
- Wide supply range: 2.7V – 5.5V DC
- Low noise and high SNR
- Analog output (envelope signal)
- Ideal for audio level detection

Voltage 2.7V – 5.5V Output Analog Price \$4 – \$8

4. INMP441 I²S MEMS MICROPHONE



FEATURES

- Digital MEMS microphone
- I²S digital output interface
- High SNR and low power
- Wide supply range: 1.8V – 3.6V
- Omni-directional microphone
- Excellent for audio recording
- Works with ESP32, Arduino, Raspberry Pi

Voltage 1.8V – 3.6V Output I²S Digital Price \$5 – \$10

5. SPH0645LM4H-B MEMS MICROPHONE



FEATURES

- Digital MEMS microphone (Knowles SPH0645)
- I²S digital output
- Supply voltage: 1.8V – 3.6V
- iFrigit Acoustic Overluster Point (AOP)
- High SNR and wide dynamic range
- Omni-directional
- Ideal for audio capture and voice projects

Voltage 1.8V – 3.6V Output I²S Digital Price \$5 – \$10

COMMON APPLICATIONS



Sound Level Meter



Audio Reactive Projects



Clap / Knock Detection



Noise Alarm System



Voice Recording



Voice / Sound Controlled Robots

COMPARISON TABLE

Module	Type	Output Type	Sensitivity	Best For	Interface
KY-037	Electret Mic + Comparator	Digital, Analog	Adjustable	Simple sound detection	DO, AO
KY-038	Electret Mic + Comparator	Digital, Analog	Adjustable	Clap / knock detection	DO, AO
MAX9814	Mic Amplifier with AGC	Analog	High (AGC)	Sound level measurement	Analog
INMP441	Digital MEMS Mic	I ² S Digital	High	Audio recording, ESP32	I ² S
SPH0645	Digital MEMS Mic	I ² S Digital	High	High quality audio capture	I ² S

TIPS

- ✓ Use Analog output for level measurement.
- ✓ Use Digital output for simple sound detection.
- ✓ Adjust the potentiometer to set desired sensitivity.
- ✓ Place the microphone away from wind and vibration.
- ✓ For high quality audio use I²S microphones.

NOTE: Prices are approximate and may vary by supplier and location.

Check your local electronics store or online marketplaces for latest prices.

Hiran Ekanayake @ UCSC

PERFECT FOR ARDUINO, ESP32, RASPBERRY PI & MORE!



MEASURE
ELECTRICAL
PARAMETERS

ELECTRICAL SENSORS

TYPES, FEATURES & MODULES

Electrical sensors detect electrical parameters such as voltage, current, power and energy and convert them into signals that can be read by microcontrollers like Arduino / ESP32.



ACCURATE
MEASUREMENT



PROTECTION
& SAFETY

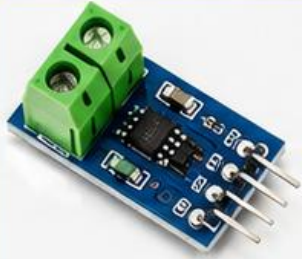


EASY TO USE
MODULES



WIDE RANGE
OF APPLICATIONS

ACS712 CURRENT SENSOR



Features

- Hall effect based
- Isolated sensing
- High accuracy
- Low power
- Fast response



Current Range
 $\pm 5A / \pm 20A / \pm 30A$

Output
Analog

INA219 CURRENT / VOLTAGE SENSOR



Features

- Measures Voltage, Current & Power
- High accuracy
- I²C Interface
- Programmable Calibration



Voltage Range
0 – 26V



Current Range
 $\pm 3.2A$

INA226 CURRENT / VOLTAGE SENSOR



Features

- High precision
- Measures Voltage, Current, Power
- I²C Interface
- 16-bit ADC
- Wide range



Voltage Range
0 – 36V



Current Range
 $\pm 5A$

ZMPT101B AC VOLTAGE SENSOR



Features

- AC Voltage Measurement
- Galvanic Isolation
- Wide Voltage Range
- Easy Interface



Voltage Range
80 – 260V AC

Output
Analog

SCT-013 CURRENT CLAMP SENSOR



Features

- Non-intrusive Current Sensing
- Easy to Use
- Safe & Isolated
- Compact Design



Current Range
0 – 100A AC

Output
Analog

PZEM-004T ENERGY METER MODULE



Features

- Measures Voltage, Current, Power, Energy, Frequency
- High Accuracy
- TTL Serial Output
- Compact Size

Voltage

80 – 260V AC

Current

0 – 100A AC

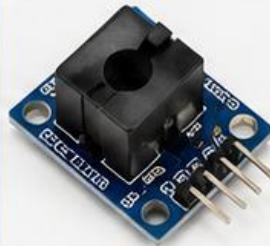
Power

0 – 22kW

Energy

0 – 99999 kWh

ZMCT103C CURRENT TRANSFORMER MODULE



Features

- AC Current Measurement
- Galvanic Isolation
- High Linearity
- Good Accuracy



Current Range
0 – 5A AC

Output
Analog

VOLTAGE DIVIDER MODULE



Features

- Scales down High Voltage
- Adjustable Ratio
- Simple & Low Cost
- Wide Applications



Input Voltage
Up to 25V DC

Output
Analog

HALL EFFECT CURRENT SENSOR (ACS758) +



Features

- Hall effect based
- Galvanic Isolation
- Low Offset
- High Accuracy
- High Bandwidth



Current Range
 $\pm 50A / \pm 100A / \pm 150A$

Output
Analog

WATT METER MODULE (HLW8012)



Features

- Measures Voltage, Current, Power, Energy
- Low Power
- Compact
- Easy to Interface



Voltage
90 – 250V AC

Power
0 – 3.6kW

APPLICATIONS



Energy
Monitoring



Power
Measurement



Industrial
Automation



Home
Automation



Renewable
Energy



Battery
Management

INTERFACES

Analog Output

I²C Interface

UART / TTL

Hiran Ekanayake @ UCSC

WORKS WITH



• • •
and more...

FORCE / WEIGHT SENSORS

Measure Force, Pressure, Weight, Load, Strain & Human Touch



High Accuracy
Precise & Reliable
Measurements



Wide Range
From grams to
tons



Easy Interface
Works with Arduino
ESP32, Raspberry Pi



Built for Projects
Robotics, IoT, Industrial
& DIY Applications

COMMON FEATURES

- ✓ Detect force, pressure or load and convert to electrical signal
- ✓ High sensitivity and good linearity
- ✓ Low power consumption
- ✓ Easy to interface (Analog / Digital via HX711, etc.)
- ✓ Wide measurement range options
- ✓ Compact and easy to integrate

1. FSR402 FORCE SENSOR



- **Type** : Force Sensitive Resistor
- **Range** : 0.1 N – 10 N (approx.)
- **Output** : Resistance change (Analog)
- **Features:**
 - Thin, Flexible & Lightweight
 - Detects applied force or pressure
 - Very low cost & easy to use
- **Applications:**
 - Touch detection, Robotics, Wearables, Pressure sensing, Human interface

Price: USD \$6 – \$12

2. HX711 LOAD CELL AMPLIFIER KIT



- **Type** : 24-bit Load Cell Amplifier
- **Supply** : 2.6 – 5.5V
- **Interface:** Digital (DT, SCK)
- **Features:**
 - High precision 24-bit ADC
 - Works with all 4/6-wire load cells
 - Built-in low noise programmable gain
 - Easy to use with Arduino/ESP32
- **Applications:**
 - Weighing scales, Industrial systems, Load measurement

Price: USD \$4 – \$10

3. 5KG LOAD CELL



- **Type** : Strain Gauge Load Cell
- **Capacity** : 5 kg
- **Output** : ~1.0 – 2.0 mV/V
- **Features:**
 - High accuracy & good stability
 - Widely used with HX711 module
 - Aluminum construction
- **Applications:**
 - Weighing scales, Hoppers, DIY balance, Inventory systems

Price: USD \$5 – \$10

4. 20KG LOAD CELL



- **Type** : Strain Gauge Load Cell
- **Capacity** : 20 kg
- **Output** : ~1.0 – 2.0 mV/V
- **Features:**
 - Higher load capacity
 - High accuracy & durability
 - Compatible with HX711 module
- **Applications:**
 - Platform scales, Hopper weighing, Industrial load measurement

Price: USD \$8 – \$15

5. 50KG LOAD CELL



- **Type** : Strain Gauge Load Cell
- **Capacity** : 50 kg
- **Output** : ~1.0 – 2.0 mV/V
- **Features:**
 - Heavy duty & high reliability
 - Excellent for industrial use
 - Works with HX711 amplifier
- **Applications:**
 - Floor scales, Tank weighing, Industrial automation

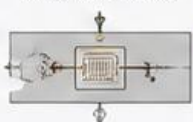
Price: USD \$10 – \$18

HOW IT WORKS

Force / Weight



Strain Gauge
(Resistance Change)



HX711 Amplifier
(Signal Conditioning)



Microcontroller
(Arduino / ESP32)



Output / Display
(Weight / Force)



COMMON APPLICATIONS



Weighing
Scales



Hopper & Tank
Weighing



Robotics &
Automation



Body Weight
Measurement



Industrial Load
Monitoring



Smart Retail &
Inventory



Tip: For best results, use a quality HX711 module and calibrate your system with known weights.



Note: Do not exceed the maximum load capacity of the sensor.



WATER / LIQUID SENSORS

FOR ARDUINO / ESP32 / IOT PROJECTS



1. FLOAT SWITCH



- Detects liquid level by float movement
- Simple ON/OFF operation
- No moving parts in contact with electronics
- Working Voltage: 3V – 24V DC
- Max Current: 0.5A
- Easy to install

USD \$2 – \$5

2. WATER LEVEL SENSOR



- Detects presence of water
- Analog output
- Comparators for digital output (D0 / A0)
- Operating Voltage: 3.3V – 5V
- LED indicator
- Low cost and easy to use

USD \$2 – \$4

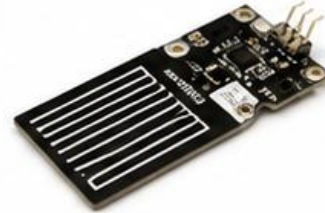
3. YF-S201 FLOW SENSOR



- Measures water flow rate
- Working Voltage: 5V DC
- Flow Range: 1 – 30 L/min
- Output: Frequency Pulse
- Accuracy: $\pm 10\%$
- Withstands water pressure up to 1.75 MPa

USD \$5 – \$8

4. CAPACITIVE WATER LEVEL SENSOR



- Detects liquid through container (non-contact)
- Capacitive sensing technology
- Operating Voltage: 3.3V – 5V
- Adjustable sensitivity
- Corrosion resistant
- Analog output

USD \$4 – \$8

5. pH METER MODULE



- Measures acidity / alkalinity
- pH Range: 0 – 14
- Working Voltage: 5V DC
- Analog output (BNC probe)
- High accuracy
- Used in water quality monitoring, hydroponics, aquariums

USD \$15 – \$35

6. TDS SENSOR MODULE



- Measures Total Dissolved Solids
- TDS Range: 0 – 1000 ppm
- Working Voltage: 3.3V – 5V
- Analog output
- Used for water purity testing, RO systems, aquariums

USD \$15 – \$30

APPLICATIONS

- Water Tanks & Reservoirs
- Water Quality Monitoring
- Aquarium Monitoring
- Hydroponics & Irrigation
- Industrial Process Control
- Leak Detection & Alert Systems
- Smart Home Automation



QUICK COMPARISON

Sensor	Detects / Measures	Output	Voltage	Key Feature	Price (USD)
 Float Switch	Liquid Level (ON/OFF)	Digital (ON/OFF)	3V – 24V DC	Simple & Reliable	\$2 – \$5
 Water Level Sensor	Water Presence / Level	Analog / Digital	3.3V – 5V	Low Cost, Easy to Use	\$2 – \$4
 YF-S201 Flow Sensor	Flow Rate	Pulse (Frequency)	5V DC	Measures Flow in L/min	\$5 – \$8
 Capacitive Level Sensor	Liquid Level (Non-contact)	Analog	3.3V – 5V	Detects Through Container	\$4 – \$8
 pH Meter Module	Acidity / Alkalinity	Analog	5V DC	pH 0 – 14, High Accuracy	\$15 – \$35
 TDS Sensor Module	Dissolved Solids (ppm)	Analog	3.3V – 5V	Tests Water Purity	\$15 – \$30

TIPS FOR USE

- Calibrate pH and TDS sensors regularly for accurate readings.
- Keep sensors clean and free from deposits.
- Use proper power supply and avoid reverse polarity.
- Ensure proper sealing for outdoor / wet environments.
- Use shielding or twisted wires for long cable lengths.

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★ These sensors help you build smart and efficient water monitoring systems for a better tomorrow. ★



Position sensors detect the position, angle or displacement of an object and convert it into an electrical signal.

POSITION SENSORS

Types, Features & Applications

Applications

- Robotics & Automation
- CNC Machines
- Industrial Control
- Mechatronics



1. POTENTIOMETER



Features

- Simple & Low cost
- Provides Analog output
- Contact based
- 10Ω to 1MΩ resistance range

Output: Analog (Voltage Divider)

Interface: Analog

Applications: Volume Control, Joysticks, Position Feedback

2. ROTARY ENCODER



Features

- Detects rotation & direction
- Incremental output
- High accuracy
- Digital output
- Optical / Mechanical types

Output: Digital (Pulse)

Interface: Digital (GPIO)

Applications: Motor Control, CNC, Robotics, User Interface

3. LINEAR POTENTIOMETER



Features

- Measures linear displacement
- Analog output
- Smooth & simple
- Various stroke lengths available

Output: Analog (Voltage Divider)

Interface: Analog

Applications: Actuator Position, Industrial Automation

4. LINEAR ENCODER (OPTICAL)



Features

- High precision
- Non-contact type
- High resolution
- Long measuring length
- Digital output

Output: Digital (Quadrature / SSI)

Interface: Digital / SSI

Applications: CNC Machines, 3D Printers, Precision Systems

5. HALL EFFECT POSITION SENSOR



Features

- Magnetic field based
- Contactless
- High reliability
- Detects linear or angular position
- Digital / Analog output

Output: Digital / Analog

Interface: Analog / Digital

Applications: Motor Commutation, Speed Detection, Position Sensing

6. RESOLVER



Features

- Rugged & reliable
- High accuracy
- Works in harsh environment
- Provides absolute position
- Analog output

Output: Analog (Sin/Cos)

Interface: Analog

Applications: Servo Motors, Aerospace, Industrial Drives

7. LVDT (LINEAR VARIABLE DIFFERENTIAL TRANSFORMER)



Features

- Very high accuracy
- Excellent linearity
- No electrical contact
- High reliability
- Measures linear displacement

Output: Analog

Interface: Analog

Applications: Industrial Measurement, Test Equipment, Position Feedback

8. MAGNETIC ENCODER (ABSOLUTE)



Features

- Absolute position
- High resolution
- Magnetic sensing
- Contactless
- Resistant to dust, oil & vibration

Output: Digital (Absolute)

Interface: SPI / I²C / SSI

Applications: Robotics, Servo Systems, Industrial Control



KEY POINTS

- Position sensors are used to detect linear or angular position.
- They can be contact or non-contact based.
- Output can be Analog, Digital, or Pulse based.
- Selection depends on accuracy, environment & application.

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COMMON INTERFACES



Analog



Digital (GPIO)



I²C



SPI



SSI



Learn More
Scan QR Code



- ✓ Capture Images & Video
- ✓ High Sensitivity
- ✓ Low Power Options
- ✓ Multiple Interfaces

IMAGE SENSORS – MODULES & FEATURES

POPULAR IMAGE SENSOR MODULES FOR ARDUINO, ESP32 & EMBEDDED SYSTEMS

COMMON INTERFACES

- DVP (Parallel)
- SPI
- I2C (for control)
- USB / MIPI CSI (on SBC)

OV7670 Camera Module



BEST FOR
BEGINNERS

KEY FEATURES

- VGA Resolution (640 x 480)
- Supports RGB, YUV Output
- Built-in Image Processing
- Adjustable: Brightness, Contrast, Saturation, White Balance

RESOLUTION VGA (640 x 480)

INTERFACE DVP (Parallel)

SUPPLY VOLTAGE 3.0V ~ 3.6V

VIEW ANGLE ~ 60°

TYPICAL USES



DIY Projects Robotics Surveillance

OV2640 Camera Module



MOST
POPULAR

KEY FEATURES

- 2 MP Resolution (1600 x 1200)
- Supports UXGA, SXGA, VGA, QVGA
- JPEG Compression Supported
- Auto Exposure, AWB, AEC, AGC

RESOLUTION 2 MP (1600 x 1200)

INTERFACE DVP (Parallel)

SUPPLY VOLTAGE 2.5V ~ 3.0V

VIEW ANGLE ~ 65°

TYPICAL USES



IoT Devices ESP32-CAM Home Security

ESP32-CAM (OV2640)



ALL-IN-ONE
SOLUTION

KEY FEATURES

- Built-in ESP32 + OV2640 Camera
- Wi-Fi + Bluetooth Support
- MicroSD Card Slot
- Ideal for IoT & Wireless Projects

RESOLUTION 2 MP (1600 x 1200)

INTERFACE DVP (Parallel)

SUPPLY VOLTAGE 5V (Via USB)

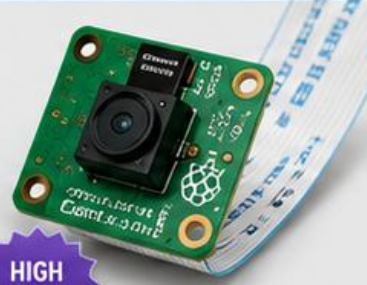
VIEW ANGLE ~ 66°

TYPICAL USES



IoT Camera Wireless Video Remote Monitoring

Raspberry Pi Camera Module v3



HIGH
QUALITY

KEY FEATURES

- 12 MP Resolution (4056 x 3040)
- Sony IMX708 Sensor
- High Dynamic Range
- Supports 1080p & 720p Video

RESOLUTION 12 MP (4056 x 3040)

INTERFACE MIPI CSI

SUPPLY VOLTAGE 3.3V

VIEW ANGLE ~ 75°

TYPICAL USES



High Quality Imaging Computer Vision Research & AI

Arducam OV5647



5 MP
SENSOR

KEY FEATURES

- 5 MP Resolution (2592 x 1944)
- Wide 69° Field of View
- Supports JPEG / RAW Output
- Works with SPI Interface

RESOLUTION 5 MP (2592 x 1944)

INTERFACE SPI

SUPPLY VOLTAGE 3.3V

VIEW ANGLE ~ 69°

TYPICAL USES



Raspberry Pi Embedded Vision AI Projects

USB Camera Module (UVC)



PLUG &
PLAY

KEY FEATURES

- USB Video Class (UVC) Compliant
- No Driver Required (Plug & Play)
- 720p / 1080p Options
- Compatible with PC & SBC

RESOLUTION 720p / 1080p

INTERFACE USB 2.0

SUPPLY VOLTAGE 5V (Via USB)

VIEW ANGLE ~ 60° – 90°

TYPICAL USES



Video Conferencing Streaming PC Vision Apps

QUICK COMPARISON

- RESOLUTION Higher is better
- IMAGE QUALITY (Low Light Performance)
- EASE OF USE (For Beginners, USD)

★★	★★★	★★★★	★★★★★	★★★★★	★★★★★	★★★★★
★★★	★★★★	★★★★★	★★★★★	★★★★★	★★★★★	★★★★★
\$5 - \$8	\$5 - \$10	\$8 - \$15	\$8 - \$35	\$25 - \$35	\$10 - \$20	\$15 - \$30

TIPS

- ✓ For IoT & wireless projects → ESP32-CAM
- ✓ For high quality stills → Raspberry Pi Camera v3
- ✓ For general purpose → OV2640
- ✓ For easy USB connection → UVC Camera Module



Scan for
Datasheets
& More Info



BIOMETRIC SENSORS

Smart Sensing for Secure Identification



1

FINGERPRINT SENSOR

R307 Optical Fingerprint Module



FEATURES

- Operating Voltage: 3.3V
- Fingerprint storage: 1000
- Interface: UART (TTL)
- Fast recognition
- Low power consumption
- High security

Approx. \$15 – \$30

APPLICATIONS: Access control, Attendance systems, Door locks, Safety systems

2

FINGERPRINT SENSOR

AS608 Optical Fingerprint Module



FEATURES

- Operating Voltage: 3.6 – 6.0V
- Fingerprint storage: 1000
- Interface: UART (TTL)
- High speed recognition
- Built-in fingerprint algorithm
- Small size & easy to use

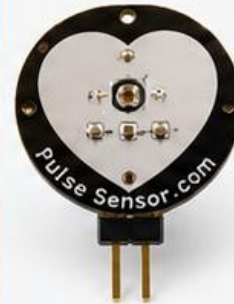
Approx. \$15 – \$25

APPLICATIONS: Access control, Time & attendance, Smart door locks, Identifications

3

PULSE SENSOR

Pulse Sensor Amped



FEATURES

- Operating Voltage: 3.3 – 5V
- Measures heart rate (BPM)
- Easy to use analog output
- Low power consumption
- Works with Arduino, ESP32, etc.

Approx. \$5 – \$8

APPLICATIONS: Fitness tracking, Heart rate monitoring, Health & wellness devices

4

HEART RATE & OXYGEN SENSOR

MAX30102 Module



FEATURES

- Operating Voltage: 1.8 – 3.3V
- Measures Heart Rate & SpO₂ (Blood Oxygen)
- I²C Interface
- Low power, high sensitivity
- Built-in LED, photodiode, optics & low noise electronics

Approx. \$5 – \$10

APPLICATIONS: Wearables, Fitness bands, Medical monitoring, IoT health devices

5

IRIS RECOGNITION SENSOR

WISE-Iris-G2



FEATURES

- Operating Voltage: 5V
- Recognition distance: 30 – 80 cm
- High accuracy
- Fast recognition (<1 sec)
- UART / USB Interface
- High security

Approx. \$70 – \$120

APPLICATIONS: High security access control, Government systems, Research applications

6

FACE RECOGNITION CAMERA

ESP32-CAM AI Module



FEATURES

- Operating Voltage: 5V
- Camera: OV2640 (2MP)
- Supports face detection & recognition (AI)
- Wi-Fi + Bluetooth (ESP32)
- Compact size

Approx. \$8 – \$15

APPLICATIONS: Smart door locks, Attendance systems, Surveillance, IoT applications

7

PALM VEIN SCANNER

R503 Palm Vein Module



FEATURES

- Operating Voltage: 5V
- Palm vein recognition
- High accuracy & security
- USB / UART Interface
- Anti-spoofing (liveness detection)

Approx. \$120 – \$180

APPLICATIONS: Banking, High security access, Time attendance, Secure authentication

8

VOICE RECOGNITION MODULE

LD3320



FEATURES

- Operating Voltage: 3.3 – 5V
- Recognizes voice commands
- Up to 80 voice commands
- UART Interface
- Easy to train & use

Approx. \$6 – \$12

APPLICATIONS: Voice controlled devices, Home automation, Security systems, Robotics

WHY USE BIOMETRIC SENSORS?



Unique to individuals



High accuracy & reliability



Improved security



Convenient & touchless options



Wide range of applications

COMMON INTERFACES



NOTE

Prices are approximate and may vary based on brand, quality and location. (USD – May 2025)



ACTUATORS – VISUAL

Display and Light Output Devices for Arduino, ESP32 & Embedded Projects

Used to give visual feedback, indication and display information in embedded systems.



1 5 mm LED



FEATURES

- Low power consumption
- Forward voltage: 1.8 – 3.3V
- Current: 10 – 20 mA
- Wide viewing angle
- Used as simple indicator lights

2 RGB LED



FEATURES

- Can display millions of colors
- Common Anode / Common Cathode
- Forward voltage: 2.0 – 3.4V (per color)
- Current: 20 mA per color
- Controlled by PWM or digital pins

3 WS2812 RGB LED (Addressable)



FEATURES

- Individually addressable LEDs
- Built-in driver IC (WS2812B)
- 5V operation, single data line
- 16.7 million colors
- Ideal for strips, matrices, rings

4 NeoPixel Ring (WS2812)



FEATURES

- Pre-arranged addressable LEDs
- Easy to use with one data pin
- 5V operation
- Bright, vibrant colors
- Available in various sizes (12, 16, 24, 32 LEDs ...)

5 16x2 LCD Display



FEATURES

- 16 characters x 2 lines
- HD44780 compatible
- 5V operation
- I2C backpack available (SDA, SCL)
- Used to display text and numbers

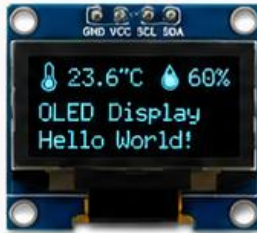
6 20x4 LCD Display



FEATURES

- 20 characters x 4 lines
- HD44780 compatible
- 5V operation
- I2C backpack supported
- More space for displaying data

7 OLED Display (SSD1306)



FEATURES

- 0.96", 128x64 pixels (common)
- I2C interface (SDA, SCL)
- Self-emissive: No backlight needed
- High contrast, wide viewing angle
- Very low power consumption

8 TFT Display (ILI9341)



FEATURES

- 2.2", 2.4", 2.8", 3.2" sizes available
- Resolution: 240x320 (2.4" typical)
- SPI interface
- 65K / 262K colors
- Good for graphics, images & UI

9 7-Segment Display



FEATURES

- Numeric display (0–9)
- Common Cathode / Anode
- Size: 0.36", 0.56", 0.8" etc.
- Controlled by digital pins or through driver (74HC595, MAX7219)
- Used for counters, timers, clocks

WHY USE VISUAL ACTUATORS?

- ✓ Provide user feedback
- ✓ Indicate system status
- ✓ Display sensor data
- ✓ Enhance user interface
- ✓ Improve user experience
- ✓ Essential for debugging



COMMON INTERFACES



Digital I/O
(LED, 7-Segment)



PWM
(LED Brightness)



I2C
(LCD, OLED)



SPI
(TFT, Displays)

Hiran Ekanayake @APPLICATIONS



Status Indicators



User Interfaces



Data Display



Alarms & Alerts



Decorative Lighting



Audio Actuators for Arduino / ESP32

Convert electrical signals into sound for alerts, alarms, music, voice and notifications.



Active Buzzer

\$1-2



Example: KY-012 / Passive Active Buzzer

- ✓ Built-in oscillator
- ✓ Produces continuous tone when powered
- ✓ Simple to use (ON/OFF)
- ✓ Voltage: 3.3V – 12V
- ✓ Current: ~15–30 mA

Best for: Simple alarms, beeps, indicators

Passive Buzzer

\$1-2



- ✓ No built-in oscillator
- ✓ Requires PWM / square wave from MCU
- ✓ Can play different tones
- ✓ Voltage: 3.3V – 12V
- ✓ Current: ~10–25 mA

Best for: Custom beeps, tunes, melody

Mini Speaker (Driver)

\$2-5



- ✓ Louder than buzzers
- ✓ Good frequency response (200 Hz – 20 kHz)
- ✓ Impedance: 4Ω / 8Ω
- ✓ Power: 0.5W – 3W
- ✓ Needs amplifier for best sound

Best for: Announcements, alerts, voice prompts

DFPlayer Mini MP3 Module

\$5-8



- ✓ Plays MP3 / WAV files from microSD card
- ✓ Communication: UART (TX/RX)
- ✓ Supply Voltage: 3.2V – 5V
- ✓ Output Power: ~3W (with small speaker)
- ✓ Easy commands via Serial

Best for: Voice messages, music playback, effects

I²S Digital MEMS Speaker (INMP441 / SPH0645 + Amp)

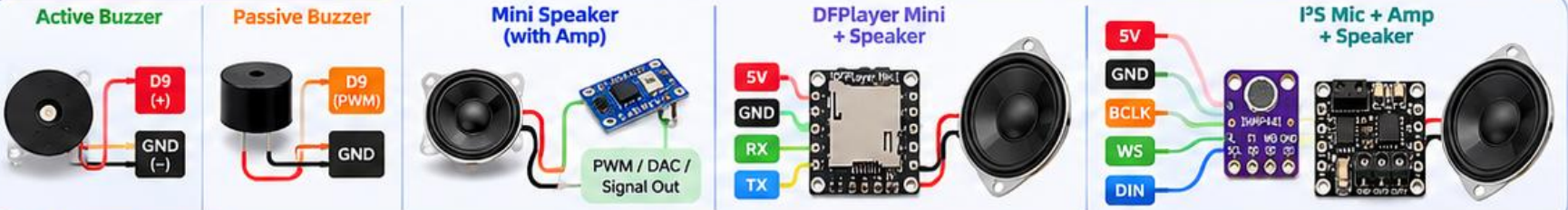
\$5-10



- ✓ High quality digital audio
- ✓ I²S interface (digital)
- ✓ Clearer voice and music
- ✓ Low noise, high fidelity
- ✓ Needs I²S mic + Class-D Amp (e.g., PAM8403, MAX98357A)

Best for: High-fidelity audio, recording & smart devices

How to Connect (Typical)



Common Applications

- Alarms & Alerts** (doorbell, security, fire)
- Notifications** (Push alerts, reminders)
- Music & Melody** (Tunes, chimes, songs)
- Voice Prompts** (Announcements, instructions)
- IoT Devices** (Smart home, wearables, robots)

Quick Comparison

Type	Loudness	Tone Control	Ease of Use	Best For
Active Buzzer	☆☆☆	☆☆☆	★★★★★	Simple beeps
Passive Buzzer	★★☆	★★★☆☆	★★★★☆	Custom tones
Mini Speaker	★★★★☆	★★★★☆	★★★★☆	Louder sound
DFPlayer Mini	★★★★☆	★★★★☆	★★★★☆	MP3 / Voice
I²S Digital Audio	★★★★★	★★★★★	★★★★☆	High quality

Pro Tips

- Use PWM pins for Passive Buzzers to create different notes.
- Always match speaker impedance with amplifier output.
- For DFPlayer, use a quality microSD card (FAT32, 8–32GB).



Popular Amplifier ICs (for Speakers)

- PAM8403 → 3W Stereo Class-D
- MAX98357A → High efficiency
- LM386 → Simple audio amplifier





MOTION ACTUATORS

Types, Features & Applications for Arduino / ESP32 / Embedded Projects



1. SG90 SERVO MOTOR



FEATURES

- Operating Voltage: 4.8 – 6V
- Stall Torque: ~1.8 kg-cm (4.8V)
- Rotation: 0° – 180°
- Control: PWM (50 Hz)
- Lightweight & compact
- Plastic gears

TYPICAL USES

Robotics, RC toys, camera mounts, mini mechanisms

2. MG996R SERVO MOTOR



FEATURES

- Operating Voltage: 4.8 – 7.2V
- Stall Torque: ~10 kg-cm (6V)
- Rotation: 0° – 180°
- Control: PWM (50 Hz)
- All metal gears
- High torque & durability

TYPICAL USES

Robot arms, pan-tilt, mechanical grippers, RC cars/planes

3. NEMA17 STEPPER MOTOR



FEATURES

- Step Angle: 1.8° (200 steps/rev)
- Voltage: 12 – 24V
- Current: 1.2 – 1.7A (typ.)
- High precision positioning
- Excellent holding torque
- Easy open-loop control

TYPICAL USES

3D Printers, CNC machines, plotters, automation

4. 28BYJ-48 STEPPER MOTOR



FEATURES

- Step Angle: 5.625° (64 steps/rev)
- Voltage: 5V
- Current: ~240mA
- Comes with ULN2003 driver
- Low cost & easy to use
- Good for light load

TYPICAL USES

DIY projects, camera sliders, small position control

5. TT GEARED MOTOR (DC)



FEATURES

- Operating Voltage: 3 – 12V
- Gear Ratio: 48:1 (typ.)
- No-load Speed: ~150 RPM (6V)
- High torque
- Compact & lightweight
- Easy mounting

TYPICAL USES

Robot cars, line followers, small automation projects

6. 12V DC GEAR MOTOR



FEATURES

- Operating Voltage: 6 – 12V
- Gear Ratio: 100:1 (typ.)
- No-load Speed: ~60 RPM (12V)
- High torque & efficiency
- Metal gear construction
- Reversible direction

TYPICAL USES

Robots, conveyors, door locks, motorized applications

7. 775 DC MOTOR



FEATURES

- Operating Voltage: 12 – 24V
- No-load Speed: ~5000 – 10000 RPM
- High power & high speed
- Durable & versatile
- Easy to adapt with gearboxes

TYPICAL USES

RC cars, power tools, pumps, high speed applications

8. BLDC MOTOR (A2212)



FEATURES

- KV Rating: 2200KV (typ.)
- Voltage: 7.4 – 11.1V (2S – 3S LiPo)
- High efficiency & long life
- Smooth & quiet operation
- Requires ESC to drive
- High power-to-weight ratio

TYPICAL USES

Drones, RC aircraft, robotics, high performance projects

MOTOR DRIVERS / CONTROLLERS (OVERVIEW)

ULN2003



- For 28BYJ-48
- 5V operation
- Easy to use
- Low current
- ~\$2 – \$4

L298N



- Dual H-Bridge
- 5 – 35V
- Up to 2A
- Widely used
- ~\$4 – \$8

TB6612FNG



- Dual H-Bridge
- 2.5 – 13.5V
- Up to 1.2A
- Low heat
- ~\$5 – \$8

A4988



- Stepper Driver
- 8 – 35V
- Up to 2A
- Microstepping
- ~\$3 – \$6

DRV8825



- Stepper Driver
- 8.2 – 45V
- Up to 2.2A
- Quiet operation
- ~\$4 – \$8

TMC2209



- Stepper Driver
- 4.75 – 29V
- Up to 2A (RMS)
- UART control
- Very quiet
- ~\$8 – \$15

BTS7960



- High Power H-Bridge
- 6 – 27V
- Up to 43A
- For big motors
- ~\$10 – \$18

COMMON APPLICATIONS



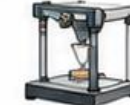
Robot Arms



Mobile Robots



CNC Machines



3D Printers



RC Vehicles



Drones



Conveyors



Automation Systems

MOTOR DRIVERS COMPARISON GUIDE

★ HOW TO CHOOSE?

- ✓ For small DC motors → L9110, DRV8833
- ✓ For medium DC motors → L298N, TB6612FNG
- ✓ For high current DC motors → BTS7960
- ✓ For stepper motors → A4988, DRV8825, TMC2209

★ — ★ Popular Motor Driver Modules for Arduino / ESP32 / Raspberry Pi Projects ★

L9110



- Compact and low cost
- Good for small DC motors
- Built-in diodes
- Easy to use
- Low standby current



Motor Voltage
2.5 – 12V



Peak Current
800mA



Channels
2



Control
IN1, IN2

DRV8833



- Dual H-Bridge driver
- Low RDS(on) for efficiency
- Built-in current limiting
- Thermal shutdown
- Small size



Motor Voltage
2.7 – 10.8V



Peak Current
1.5A



Channels
2



Control
IN1, IN2

TB6612FNG



- Dual H-Bridge driver
- High efficiency
- Low standby current
- Built-in thermal shutdown
- Forward / Reverse / Brake



Motor Voltage
2.5 – 13.5V



Peak Current
1.2A (3.2A Peak)



Channels
2



Control
PWM / IN1, IN2

L293D



- Quadruple half-H driver
- Can drive DC motors and stepper motors
- Built-in back EMF diodes
- Very popular & reliable



Motor Voltage
4.5 – 36V



Peak Current
600mA
(per channel)



Channels
2



Control
IN1~IN4

L298N



- Dual full-bridge driver
- High voltage & current
- Built-in heat sink
- Enable pin for speed control
- Widely used



Motor Voltage
5 – 35V



Peak Current
2A
(per channel)



Channels
2



Control
ENA/ENB
IN1~IN4

A4988



- Stepper motor driver
- Easy to use
- Microstepping up to 1/16
- Built-in current regulator
- Great for 3D printers and CNC



Motor Voltage
8 – 35V



Current
2A
(max with cooling)



Microstepping
1, 1/2, 1/4,
1/8, 1/16



Interface
STEP/DIR

DRV8825



- Stepper motor driver
- Microstepping up to 1/32
- Low RDS(on)
- Built-in current regulation
- Silent & efficient



Motor Voltage
8.2 – 45V



Current
2.2A
(max with cooling)



Microstepping
1, 1/2, 1/4,
1/8, 1/16, 1/32



Interface
STEP/DIR

TMC2209



- Ultra silent stepper driver
- UART communication
- Microstepping up to 1/256
- StallGuard (sensorless homing)
- CoolStep (auto current)
- Great for 3D printers



Motor Voltage
4.75 – 29V



Current
2.8A RMS
(3.2A Peak)



Microstepping
1 – 256



Interface
STEP/DIR
UART

BTS7960



- High current dual H-Bridge driver
- Perfect for large DC motors
- Very low RDS(on)
- Over current, over temperature protection



Motor Voltage
6 – 27V



Peak Current
43A
(per channel)



Channels
2



Control
PWM /
IN1, IN2

QUICK COMPARISON

Driver	Type	Motor Type	Max Current (Per Channel)	Motor Voltage
L9110	H-Bridge	DC	800mA	2.5 – 12V
DRV8833	H-Bridge	DC	1.5A	2.7 – 10.8V
TB6612FNG	H-Bridge	DC	1.2A (3.2A Peak)	2.5 – 13.5V
L293D	H-Bridge	DC / Stepper	600mA	4.5 – 36V
L298N	H-Bridge	DC / Stepper	2A	5 – 35V
A4988	Stepper	Stepper	2A	8 – 35V
DRV8825	Stepper	Stepper	2.2A	8.2 – 45V
TMC2209	Stepper	Stepper	2.8A RMS	4.75 – 29V
BTS7960	H-Bridge	DC	43A	6 – 27V



PROTECTION FEATURES

Most modules include protection against over-current, over-temperature and reverse voltage.



COOLING

For high current applications, use proper heat sinks and ensure good ventilation.



PWM CONTROL

Use PWM on ENA/ENB pins (or dedicated PWM pins) for speed control of DC motors.



NOTES

Always check the datasheet before use.
Do not exceed voltage or current ratings.

DC = DC Motor

Stepper = Stepper Motor

PWM = Pulse Width Modulation

RELAY MODULES

Switch Anything, Control Everything!

Safe • Reliable • Easy to Use



Home Automation



Industrial Control



DIY Projects



Safety & Protection

1 1-CHANNEL RELAY MODULE

FEATURES

- ✓ Controls 1 high-power appliance
- ✓ Opto-isolated for protection
- ✓ LED indicator (Power & Relay)
- ✓ Trigger: High/Low Level



- ⚡ Control Voltage: 5V DC
- ⚡ Load Voltage: 250V AC / 30V DC
- ⚡ Max Load Current: 10A
- 📏 Size: 50 x 26 x 18 mm

BEST FOR: Simple switching, small DIY projects

2 2-CHANNEL RELAY MODULE

FEATURES

- ✓ Controls 2 devices independently
- ✓ Opto-isolated
- ✓ LED indicators
- ✓ Trigger: High/Low Level



- ⚡ Control Voltage: 5V DC
- ⚡ Load Voltage: 250V AC / 30V DC
- ⚡ Max Load Current: 10A (per channel)
- 📏 Size: 50 x 43 x 18 mm

BEST FOR: Controlling two appliances, automation

3 4-CHANNEL RELAY MODULE

FEATURES

- ✓ Controls 4 devices independently
- ✓ Opto-isolated
- ✓ LED indicators
- ✓ Trigger: High/Low Level



- ⚡ Control Voltage: 5V DC
- ⚡ Load Voltage: 250V AC / 30V DC
- ⚡ Max Load Current: 10A (per channel)
- 📏 Size: 75 x 55 x 20 mm

BEST FOR: Home automation, multi-device control

4 8-CHANNEL RELAY MODULE

FEATURES

- ✓ Controls 8 devices independently
- ✓ Opto-isolated
- ✓ LED indicators
- ✓ Trigger: High/Low Level



- ⚡ Control Voltage: 5V DC
- ⚡ Load Voltage: 250V AC / 30V DC
- ⚡ Max Load Current: 10A (per channel)
- 📏 Size: 138 x 55 x 20 mm

BEST FOR: Large automation systems, equipment control

5 SOLID STATE RELAY (SSR) MODULE

FEATURES

- ✓ No moving parts
- ✓ Silent operation
- ✓ Fast switching
- ✓ Long life
- ✓ Opto-isolated



- ⚡ Control Voltage: 3-32V DC
- ⚡ Load Voltage: 24-380V AC
- ⚡ Max Load Current: 2A / 5A / 10A / 25A*
- 📏 Size: 45 x 30 x 20 mm

BEST FOR: Silent switching, frequent ON/OFF cycles

6 HIGH POWER RELAY MODULE

FEATURES

- ✓ High current handling
- ✓ Suitable for demanding appliances
- ✓ Opto-isolated
- ✓ LED indicator



- ⚡ Control Voltage: 12V DC
- ⚡ Load Voltage: 250V AC / 30V DC
- ⚡ Max Load Current: 20A / 30A
- 📏 Size: 60 x 31 x 25 mm

BEST FOR: High power loads, motors, heaters

7 LATCHING RELAY MODULE

FEATURES

- ✓ Maintains last state without power
- ✓ Bi-stable (Set / Reset)
- ✓ Low power consumption
- ✓ Opto-isolated



- ⚡ Control Voltage: 5V DC
- ⚡ Load Voltage: 250V AC / 30V DC
- ⚡ Max Load Current: 10A
- 📏 Size: 52 x 34 x 18 mm

BEST FOR: Battery powered projects, energy saving

8 RELAY MODULE WITH OPTOCOUPLER

FEATURES

- ✓ Optocoupler isolation
- ✓ Protects microcontroller from high voltage
- ✓ Stable & reliable
- ✓ LED indicators



- ⚡ Control Voltage: 5V DC
- ⚡ Load Voltage: 250V AC / 30V DC
- ⚡ Max Load Current: 10A (per channel)
- 📏 Size: Varies (1/2/4/8 Channel)

BEST FOR: Microcontroller protection, industrial use

COMMON FEATURES (ALL MODULES)



Opto-isolation for safety



Easy to use with Arduino / ESP32 / Raspberry Pi



Screw terminals for secure connections



LED indicators for status monitoring



Overload & short circuit protection (Design dependent)

NOTE:

- Always use within the specified voltage and current limits.
- For inductive loads (motors, pumps), use snubber circuits if needed.
- Ensure proper ventilation for high current applications.

LEGEND



Control Voltage (Logic Side)



Load Voltage (High Power Side)



Max Load Current (Per Channel)
(L x W x Size)

WHY SOLENOIDS & VALVES?

- ✓ Convert electrical energy to mechanical motion
- ✓ Fast response & high reliability
- ✓ Used in automation, robotics, irrigation, industrial control, appliances & more

SOLENOIDS & VALVES

Types, Features & Applications



Fast Response



High Precision



Reliable & Durable



Easy to Control



Wide Range of Applications

5V SOLENOID



- Compact size
- Pull type
- Low power consumption
- Quick response

Voltage: 5V DC

Price: \$5 – \$10

- Use: Locking, Latching, Small automation

12V SOLENOID



- Stronger force
- Push/Pull type
- Durable metal construction
- Easy mounting

Voltage: 12V DC

Price: \$8 – \$15

- Use: Automation, Vending machines, Door locks

SOLENOID DOOR LOCK



- Secure locking
- Holding force
- Fail-safe operation (optional)
- Compact & robust

Voltage: 12V DC

Price: \$8 – \$20

- Use: Electronic door locks, Cabinets, Access control

WATER SOLENOID VALVE



- Controls water flow ON/OFF
- Available in NC / NO type
- Easy installation
- Common sizes: 1/8", 1/4", 3/8", 1/2"

Voltage: 12V DC

Price: \$10 – \$20

- Use: Water dispensers, RO purifiers, Irrigation, Coffee machines

AIR SOLENOID VALVE (2/2 WAY)



- Controls air flow ON/OFF
- 2-Port 2-Way Normally Closed
- Brass body
- High durability

Voltage: 12V DC / 24V DC

Price: \$10 – \$18

- Use: Pneumatic systems, Air compressors, Automation

AIR SOLENOID VALVE (5/2 WAY)



- 5-Port 2-Position
- Controls double acting cylinders
- Fast switching
- High flow capacity

Voltage: 24V DC

Price: \$18 – \$35

- Use: Industrial automation, Pneumatic actuators

NORMALLY CLOSED (NC) VALVE

NC – Normally Closed



- Closed when de-energized
- Opens when energized
- Safe for fail-close applications
- Brass / SS body options

Voltage: 12V DC / 24V DC

Price: \$10 – \$25

- Use: Water control, Fuel control, Safety shut-off systems

NORMALLY OPEN (NO) VALVE

NO – Normally Open



- Open when de-energized
- Closes when energized
- Ideal for fail-open applications
- Brass / SS body options

Voltage: 12V DC / 24V DC

Price: \$10 – \$25

- Use: Air release, Ventilation, Drain systems

PROPORTIONAL SOLENOID VALVE



- Variable flow control
- High precision
- Analog / PWM control
- Used in precise automation

Voltage: 24V DC

Price: \$30 – \$60

- Use: Flow regulation, Pressure control, Robotic systems

APPLICATION AREAS



Industrial Automation



Water Treatment & Irrigation



Security & Access Control



Automotive Systems



Medical Equipment

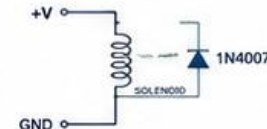


Home Appliances & Vending

TIPS FOR USE

- ✓ Always check voltage & current rating
- ✓ Use flyback diode for DC coils
- ✓ Choose NC or NO based on safety requirement
- ✓ Ensure proper mounting & orientation
- ✓ Use correct valve size for your application

DC SOLENOID WIRING (WITH FLYBACK DIODE)



Note: Prices are approximate (USD) and may vary by supplier, brand & quantity.



Essential Components
for Your Projects



PUMPS & FANS

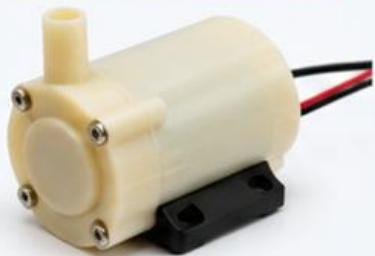
TYPES, FEATURES & APPLICATIONS



Works with Arduino,
ESP32, Raspberry Pi

PUMPS

MINI WATER PUMP



Compact submersible pump ideal for small water transfer applications.

FEATURES

- Operating Voltage: 3V – 6V DC
- Flow Rate: 120 – 240 L/H
- Max Lift: 40 – 110 cm
- Current: 130 – 220 mA
- Size: 43 x 30 x 32 mm
- Quiet operation, lightweight

APPLICATIONS

- Small aquariums
- Water circulation
- DIY projects, science models

PRICE: \$5 – \$10

PERISTALTIC PUMP



Accurate low-volume fluid transfer without fluid contacting the pump mechanism.

FEATURES

- Operating Voltage: 6V – 24V DC
- Flow Rate: 0.1 – 300 ml/min
- Tubing Size: ID 1 – 4 mm
- Self-priming up to 2 m
- Reversible direction
- Chemical resistant tubing

APPLICATIONS

- Dosing chemicals
- Medical / lab equipment
- Water treatment, DIY robotics

PRICE: \$12 – \$25

DIAPHRAGM PUMP



High pressure pump suitable for continuous duty and various liquid transfer tasks.

FEATURES

- Operating Voltage: 12V / 24V DC
- Flow Rate: 1 – 5 LPM
- Max Pressure: 0.6 – 0.9 MPa
- Self-priming up to 2 – 3 m
- Dry run capable
- Durable and reliable

APPLICATIONS

- Spraying systems
- Car / bike wash
- Agriculture, misting, RO systems

PRICE: \$15 – \$30

FANS

5V BRUSHLESS FAN



Efficient low voltage fan for cooling electronic components and small enclosures.

FEATURES

- Operating Voltage: 5V DC
- Size: 50 x 50 x 10 mm
- Speed: 4000 – 6000 RPM
- Air Flow: 4 – 10 CFM
- Current: 0.12 – 0.20 A
- Low noise, energy efficient

APPLICATIONS

- Arduino / ESP32 projects
- Electronic cooling
- 3D printer, enclosures, DIY

PRICE: \$3 – \$8

12V COOLING FAN



High airflow fan for effective cooling in more demanding applications.

FEATURES

- Operating Voltage: 12V DC
- Size: 80 x 80 x 25 mm
- Speed: 2000 – 3000 RPM
- Air Flow: 25 – 40 CFM
- Current: 0.15 – 0.30 A
- Long life, strong airflow

APPLICATIONS

- PC / electronics cooling
- Power supplies
- Industrial / robotics projects

PRICE: \$4 – \$10



WHY USE PUMPS & FANS?

They help in fluid transfer, pressure generation, cooling and ventilation in countless DIY, industrial and automation applications.



GENERAL TIPS

- Use proper voltage & current supply
- Ensure tight connections
- For pumps: avoid dry running
- For fans: ensure proper airflow path



INTERFACING

Pumps & fans can be controlled using transistors, MOSFETs, relays or motor drivers with Arduino / ESP32.



PRICE NOTE

Prices are approximate (USD) and may vary based on brand, quality, region and supplier.



MAKE YOUR PROJECTS BETTER

Choose the right pump or fan for your needs and improve the performance and reliability of your projects!



HEATING / COOLING ACTUATORS



Convert Electrical Energy into Heat or Cooling for Embedded & IoT Applications



Used in: 3D Printers, Incubators, HVAC, Medical Devices, Lab Equipment, Smart Home, Automotive, Industrial Automation



Controlled by: Arduino, ESP32, Raspberry Pi, PLC etc.

1. HEATING ELEMENT

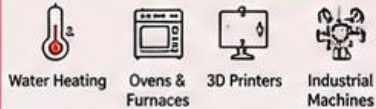


(Tubular Heater)

FEATURES

- High heating efficiency
- Fast heat generation
- Available in various power ratings (50W – 3kW+)
- Operates on AC or DC
- Robust and long life

TYPICAL APPLICATIONS



PRICE: \$5 – \$20 USD

2. CERAMIC HEATER



(PTC Ceramic Heater)

FEATURES

- PTC (Positive Temperature Coefficient)
- Self-regulating temperature
- Even heat distribution
- Compact & lightweight
- Safe, no open flame

TYPICAL APPLICATIONS



PRICE: \$8 – \$20 USD

3. HEATER CARTRIDGE



(Cartridge Heater)

FEATURES

- High power density
- Fast response
- Available in various sizes (6mm – 20mm dia)
- Operates up to 600°C+
- Easy to install

TYPICAL APPLICATIONS



PRICE: \$6 – \$18 USD

4. Peltier MODULE

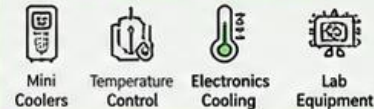


(TEC1-12706)

FEATURES

- Solid state (no moving parts)
- Can be used for heating or cooling
- Compact and lightweight
- Operates on DC (12V typical)
- Temperature difference up to ~67°C

TYPICAL APPLICATIONS



PRICE: \$5 – \$10 USD

5. SILICONE HEATER PAD



(Silicone Heater Pad)

FEATURES

- Flexible and thin
- Uniform heat distribution
- Water & moisture resistant
- Easy to mount on flat or curved surfaces
- Operates on 12V / 24V

TYPICAL APPLICATIONS



PRICE: \$10 – \$20 USD

6. THERMOELECTRIC COOLER (FAN + HEATSINK OPTIONAL)

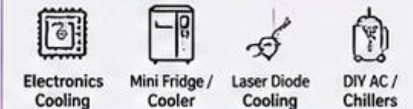


(Peltier + Heatsink + Fan)

FEATURES

- Active cooling using Peltier effect
- Quick temperature reduction
- Requires heatsink & fan for better performance
- Compact & reliable
- Operates on DC

TYPICAL APPLICATIONS

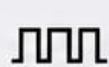


PRICE: \$10 – \$25 USD

GENERAL NOTES

- ✓ Select actuator based on required temperature, power, size, and environment.
- ✓ Use appropriate drivers / relay / MOSFET / PWM modules for safe control.
- ✓ Always use thermal insulation and safety protection (fuse, thermostat, heat sink etc.).
- ✓ Ensure proper ventilation for cooling actuators.

CONTROL METHODS



PWM Control
(For Power Regulation)



MOSFET / SSR
(High Power Switching)



Temperature
Sensor + PID
Control



Fan / Heatsink
(For Better Heat
Dissipation)

QUICK COMPARISON

Actuator	Type	Operating Voltage	Max Temp / ΔT	Power Range	Best For
Heating Element	Resistive	AC 110V / 220V	Up to 800°C+	50W – 3000W+	High power heating
Ceramic Heater	PTC	AC / DC (12V – 240V)	Up to 300°C	20W – 200W	Safe, self-regulating heat
Heater Cartridge	Resistive	12V / 24V / 220V	Up to 600°C+	30W – 200W	Compact high temp heating
Peltier Module	Thermoelectric	DC 5V – 15V	ΔT up to ~67°C	30W – 60W	Heating or Cooling
Silicone Heater Pad	Resistive	12V / 24V / 110V / 220V	Up to 200°C	10W – 200W	Flexible surface heating
TEC + Fan + Heatsink	Thermoelectric	DC 12V	ΔT up to ~67°C	30W – 60W	Active cooling



SAFETY FIRST!

High temperatures and high power can be dangerous. Always follow electrical safety guidelines and use appropriate protection.

Hiran Ekanayake @ UCSC



Use Fuse



Use Thermal Cut-off



Proper Insulation



Keep Away from Water